



Aras Innovator 33

Visual Collaboration Administrator Guide

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Table of Contents

Send Us Your Comments	5
Glossary of Terms.....	6
1 Visual Collaboration	7
2 Visual Collaboration Installation	8
2.1 Prerequisites	8
2.2 Installing Aras PDF Viewer package.....	8
2.2.1 Requesting a feature license	9
2.2.2 Installing the license	9
3 Enabling an ItemType for Secure Social.....	11
4 Discussion Templates	13
4.1 DiscussionTemplate	13
4.2 FeedTemplate	18
4.3 FileSelectorTemplate	21
4.4 DiscussionTemplateView	24
4.5 SecureMessageViewTemplate	25
4.6 Individual DiscussionDefinition.....	26
5 Display and Styling Control	29
5.1 Change the Secure Message Template Style	29
5.2 Set Sidebar Color for ItemType.....	31
5.3 Configure Form Tooltip Text	33
5.4 Configure File Tooltip Text.....	35
5.5 Setting Visibility of Sidebar and Discussion Panel.....	36
6 Notifications	38
6.1 Set up of Conversion Server and Agent Service	38
6.2 Enabling Notifications.....	38
6.3 Setting Polling Interval	39
6.4 Notification Preferences	39
6.5 Notifications in the Aras Web Client.....	40
6.6 Configuration of Email Notifications	40
6.7 Result of Email Notifications	41
7 Message Visibility	43
7.1 ItemType Configuration Options	43
7.2 Identity Selection.....	44
7.3 Display of Posted Messages.....	46
7.4 Special Handling for Private Messages	46
8 Managing Forums	47

- 8.1 Force Users to Follow Forums 47
- 8.2 Set a Forum to Inactive 50
- 8.3 Delete a Forum 51
- 9 Viewer Configuration..... 52**
 - 9.1 Available Viewers..... 52
 - 9.2 Converting and Viewing 3D CAD Files 53
 - 9.2.1 *Setting the Proper FileType for 3D PDF Files*..... 54
 - 9.2.2 *Browser Compliance Check for 3D Viewing*..... 54
 - 9.3 Measurement Units Settings for Viewers..... 55
 - 9.4 Configuring Viewer Toolbars..... 56
 - 9.5 Configuring Browsers for Printable View 57
 - 9.6 Configuring the Simulation Viewer 57
- 10 Additional Preference Settings 63**
- Appendix A – Standard ItemType Configuration..... 65**
 - Part 65
 - Document 66
 - CAD Document..... 66
 - Express ECO 67
- Appendix B – Notes on Exported AML..... 69**

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Glossary of Terms

The table below defines all relevant terms, acronyms, and abbreviations used in the document.

Term	Definition
Secure Social Messaging	Also known as “Secure Social”, it is the messaging subsystem that underlies Aras Visual Collaboration. It allows posting secure messages in the context of Innovator Items, replying to secure messages thus creating Secure Message threads, aggregating secure messages and/or history events into Discussions.
Secure Message (SM)	A message entered interactively in the context of an Innovator Item or as a mark-up in a file viewer integrated with Aras Innovator. A Secure Message can be posted to one and only one Board. It can be aggregated into unlimited number of Discussions.
Board	A Message Board (wall) where Secure Messages are posted and stored. Each Board belongs to one and only one Innovator Item. A single Innovator Item can have zero or one Board.
Discussion	Item-centric set of Secure Messages and/or history events from one or multiple Boards that are a result of read-only aggregation based on one or more Feeds. Each Innovator Item can have zero or one Discussion.
Feed	A function in Innovator that returns a set of Secure Messages and/or History records associated with a set of items.
Forum	A free-form subject exchange of Secure Messages. Forum might also reference individual items and/or searches to incorporate the Secure Messages associated with these items and/or search results, into the <i>Forum</i> .
SM Reply	A Secure Message that is entered in reply to any other Secure Message. All the SM replies subordinate to the top-level Secure Message that originates the SM thread.
SM Thread	A combination of the top-level Secure Message that originated the SM Thread, any replies to it, and any tags (Flagged and Rating) associated with the SMs in the Thread.
My Discussions	The main entry point to Aras Visual Collaboration, located in the TOC under My Innovator .
VC	Short for Visual Collaboration, the end-user functionality
SSVC	Short for Secure Social Visual Collaboration, which means the combination of both the messaging sub-system and end-user functionality

1 Visual Collaboration

The Visual Collaboration Administration Guide describes the administrative capabilities for configuration of Aras Visual Collaboration.

A whole new dimension of secure social communication is opened with the introduction of Aras Visual Collaboration. Focused on the ability to easily view and comment on graphical file content, Aras Visual Collaboration provides security, control, and context to your day-to-day product development discussions. It includes threaded discussions with comments and replies, configurable discussion forums, and the ability to easily view and graphically comment on all your file content, including 3D models, drawings, and Office documents. Powerful aggregation capability for files and comments pulls together the needed information where and when you need it.

The Aras Visual Collaboration end user functionality and the features of the User Interface are described in detail in the Online Help section **Just Ask Innovator**. Refer to the topics under **End User --> Item Window** to learn more about the features and the end user functions of Aras Visual Collaboration.

2 Visual Collaboration Installation

For Visual Collaboration to function properly, Aras Innovator requires the Aras PDF Viewer to be installed. Aras PDF Viewer is a feature included in Aras Innovator to display PDF documents as part of the Visual Collaboration feature. However, the technology used to make feature display PDFs is browser specific. Users may experience differences in behavior when loading in different browsers. While all browsers provide the same functionality, the user experience will be slightly different.

The PDF Viewer installation includes updates to the Aras Innovator database and code tree.

2.1 Prerequisites

Before installing the PDF Viewer package, confirm that the server has **Microsoft Visual C++ 2010 Redistributable** installed. If required, the package may be downloaded from the Microsoft web site:

- **Microsoft Visual C++ 2010 Redistributable Package (x64)**
<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/help/2977003/the-latest-supported-visual-c-downloads>

2.2 Installing Aras PDF Viewer package

Before proceeding with the installation, confirm that the **Microsoft Visual C++ 2010 Redistributable** package is installed on the server machine.

1. Unzip the ArasPDFViewer.zip file on the server.

Note: Step 2 should only be done if Windows Authentication is set up for the instance. If it is not, users can skip this step.

2. Open the **OAuthServer.Plugins.json** file located at the root of the Aras OAuth server folder.
3. Add the pdftron user to DeniedDomainUsers of the WindowsUserByNameClaimMapper plugin in the OAuthServer.Plugins.json as follows:


```
"Options": {
    "AuthenticationType": "WindowsRemote",
    "AllowedDomainNames": "^ARAS-CORP$",
    "AllowedDomainUsers": ".+",
    "DeniedDomainUsers": "^admin$|^root$|^vadm |^pdftronuser$"
```
4. Clear the browser cache.
5. Next, you need to import the database package with the Package Import Export Utilities For more information about using this tool, refer to the *Aras Innovator 33 - Package Import Export Utilities* documentation.
 - a. You need to enable the **Super User** user to perform this step.
 - b. Go to the **\\PackageImportExportUtilities\\Import** folder and run the **Import.exe** file.
 - c. Input the connection information:
 - **Server:** an Aras Innovator connection URL
 - **Database:** a target Aras Innovator database
 - **Username:** root

- **Password:** a password of the **root** user, the default is **innovator**
 - **Target Release:** a target release version
 - **Description:** a PDF Viewer Package
 - **Manifest File Path:** a manifest is found at `\\Imports\\import.mf`
 - **Available for Import:** **PDFViewer**
 - **Type:** **Merge**
 - **Mode:** **Thorough Mode**
- d. Click the **Import** button.
 - e. After the import has been completed, disable the **SuperUser** user.
 6. Log into Aras Innovator as an administrator.
 7. Go to **Contents --> Administration --> Users** and open the **pdftron_user** User for editing.
 8. Set the password for the **pdftron_user** User as required, **Logon enabled: true** and click **Save, Unclaim and Close**.
 9. At the root of Aras Innovator code tree, open the **InnovatorServerConfig.xml** file for editing.
 10. Add the following before the closing `</Innovator>` tag, filling in the password set in Step 10 above.

```
...
<operating_parameter key="pdftron_user" value="pdftron_user|innovator" />
</Innovator>
```

11. Save and close the **InnovatorServerConfig.xml** file.
12. Confirm that either a current version of the **Aras.PremierSubscription** or a current version of the **Aras.EssentialSubscription** Feature licenses are activated in the database.
13. Log into Aras Innovator as an administrator.
14. Go to **Contents --> Administration --> Feature Licenses** and search for the **Aras.PremiereSubscription**, **Aras.EssentialSubscription**, and **Aras.PDFViewer** licenses.
15. If the licenses are not found, you can request them at licenses@aras.com if being a subscriber.

Note: Common Feature License bundles such as **Aras.EssentialsSubscription** and **Aras.PremierSubscription** include the **Aras.SecureSocial** license, but the **Aras.PDFViewer** license must be activated separately.

The PDFViewer must be run as a 64-bit application. To confirm that the application is running in 64-bit mode, check the settings on the assigned **Application Pool User** in IIS.

2.2.1 Requesting a feature license

To request a feature license activation key, customers with an active Aras subscription can send an email to licenses@aras.com or your account representative in the following format:

- Subject: PDF Viewer Activation Key Required
- Body: an Aras Innovator version

You will receive a reply containing the Feature License activation key.

2.2.2 Installing the license

Once you have the activation key, install the feature license as follows:

1. Log into Aras Innovator as an administrator.

2. Click the User menu icon  and select Activate Feature from the dropdown menu.

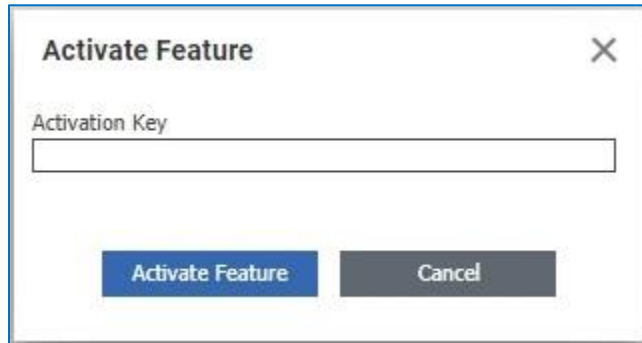


Figure 1.

3. Paste the acquired activation key and click the **Activate Feature** button.
A success message should pop up.

3 Enabling an ItemType for Secure Social

When an ItemType is enabled for Secure Social Messaging, the tear-off window for that item will include a colored sidebar on the left side of the window plus a Discussion Panel that provides the Visual Collaboration (VC) functionality.

A detailed description of the Visual Collaboration User Interface is described in the Online Help section of **Just Ask Innovator**.

Not all ItemTypes are enabled by default. They can be enabled only by an administrator.

To enable social content for an ItemType, do the following:

1. Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
2. Go to Contents --> **Administration** --> **ItemTypes**.
3. Create a **New ItemType** or open an existing ItemType, for example, **Manufacturer Part** ItemType from the search grid for edit.

The screenshot shows the 'Manufacturer Part' ItemType configuration window. The 'Enable for Secure Social' button is highlighted in red. The configuration panel includes various settings such as Name, Singular Label, Plural Label, Show Parameters Tab, History Template, Versioning, Search, and Implementation Type. The 'Implementation Type' section shows 'Single Item' selected. The 'Enable for Secure Social' button is located at the bottom right of the configuration panel.

Name	Label	Data Type	Data Source [...]	Le...	Pr...	Sc...	Req...	Uni...	Inde...	Hid...	Hid...	Align...	Width	Sort ...
classification	Classification	String		512			☐	☐	☐	☒	☒	Left		128
config_id		Item	Manufacturer Part				☒	☐	☐	☒	☒	Left		2688
created_by_id		Item	User				☒	☐	☐	☒	☒	Left		640

Figure 2.

4. A new **Enable for Secure Social** button is seen on the right side of the window.
5. Click this button to enable the **Manufacturer Part** ItemType for secure social content.

Note: For the **Is Relationship** ItemTypes, enabling for Secure Social is not possible.

The ItemType is now enabled for secure social.

6. Select the **Secure Social** tab.

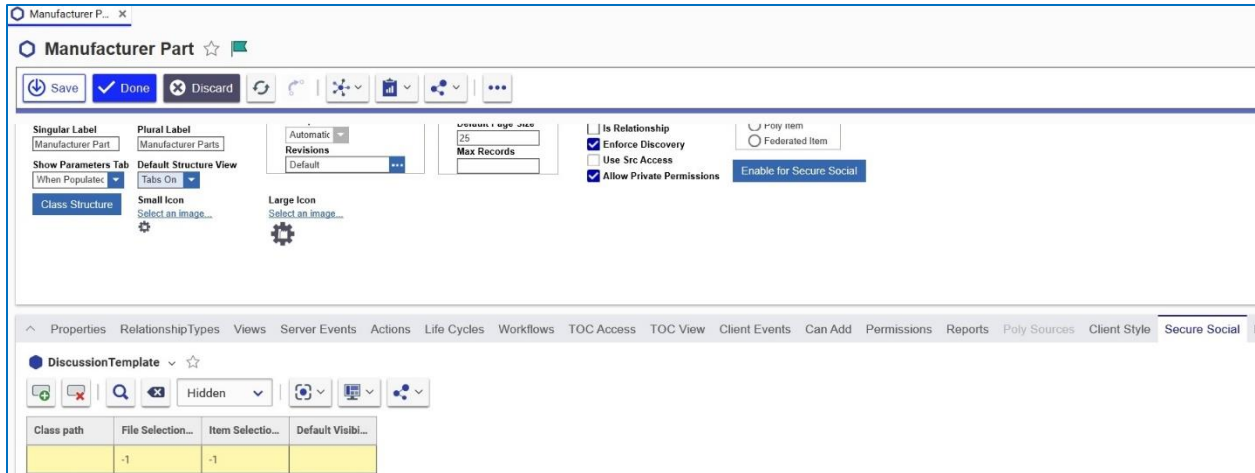


Figure 3.

A single **DiscussionTemplate** with the following default properties has already been added in the relationship grid.

- **Class path: Root**
- **File Selection Depth: -1**
- **Item Selection: -1**

Note: It is not possible to save the **Enabled for Secure Social** ItemType without setting the **DiscussionTemplate** for **Root** Class path.

7. Click  and  to close the window.

For more information on the administrator configurations to the **DiscussionTemplate**, refer to [Aggregation of Secure MessagesDiscussionTemplate](#) in the next section.

4 Discussion Templates

The Secure Social Messaging Subsystem allows the end user to post secure messages in the context of Innovator Items, reply to secure messages to create Secure Message Threads, and aggregate secure messages and/or history events into Discussions.

When an end user opens the Discussion Panel in an item window, the user sees Secure Messages which are either entered by other users or which come in an automated way from History records. Each discussion represents a set of Secure Messages aggregated from various Boards directly or through other discussions (recursively).

The administrator has the capability to aggregate the secure messages in this discussion panel by configuring the **DiscussionTemplate** of the associated ItemType.

The aggregation of the Secure Messages occurs based on either DiscussionTemplate associated with the item's ItemType or **DiscussionDefinition** associated with the item.

When an ItemType is enabled for social content, it has at least one **DiscussionTemplate** associated with it. The administrator has the capability of configuring the **DiscussionTemplate** of an ItemType or the **DiscussionDefinition** associated with the item.

4.1 DiscussionTemplate

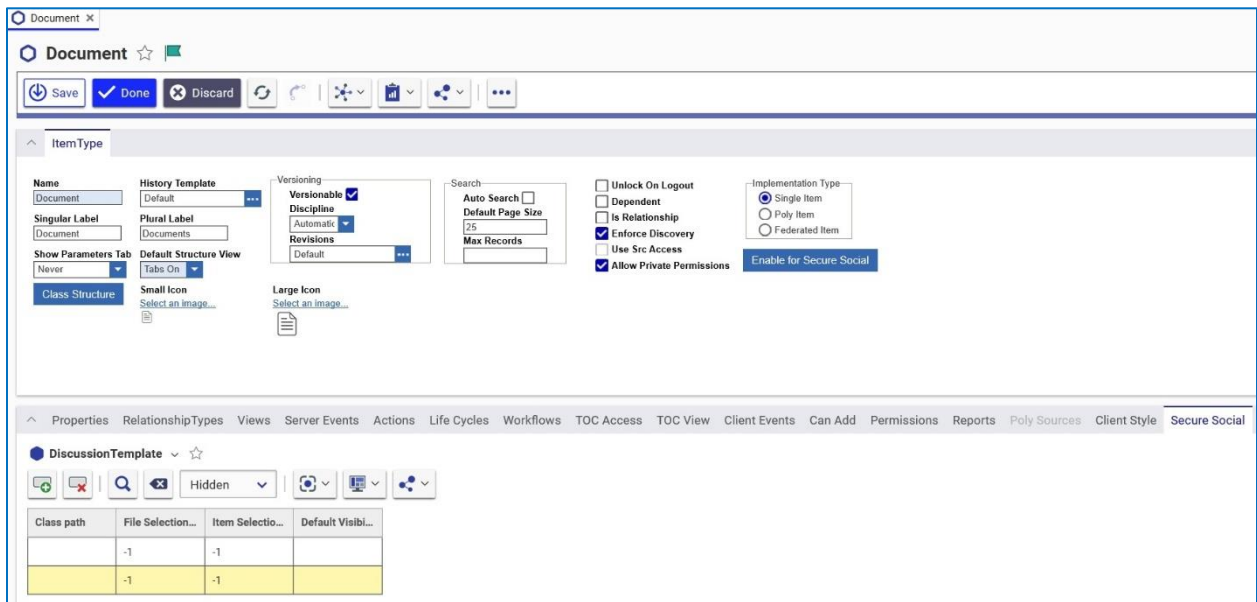
The **DiscussionTemplate** is a relationship type with ItemType as its source. The **DiscussionTemplate** serves the following purposes:

- Defines **Feeds** that are used for aggregating Secure Messages and History records for items of this type.
- Defines **FileSelectors** that are used for finding **Files** associated with the items of this type.

An administrator can make configurations to the **DiscussionTemplate** by doing the following:

1. Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
2. Go to Contents --> **Administration** --> **ItemTypes**.
3. Run the search and open an ItemType, for example **Document** ItemType, for edit.
4. Select the **Secure Social** tab.

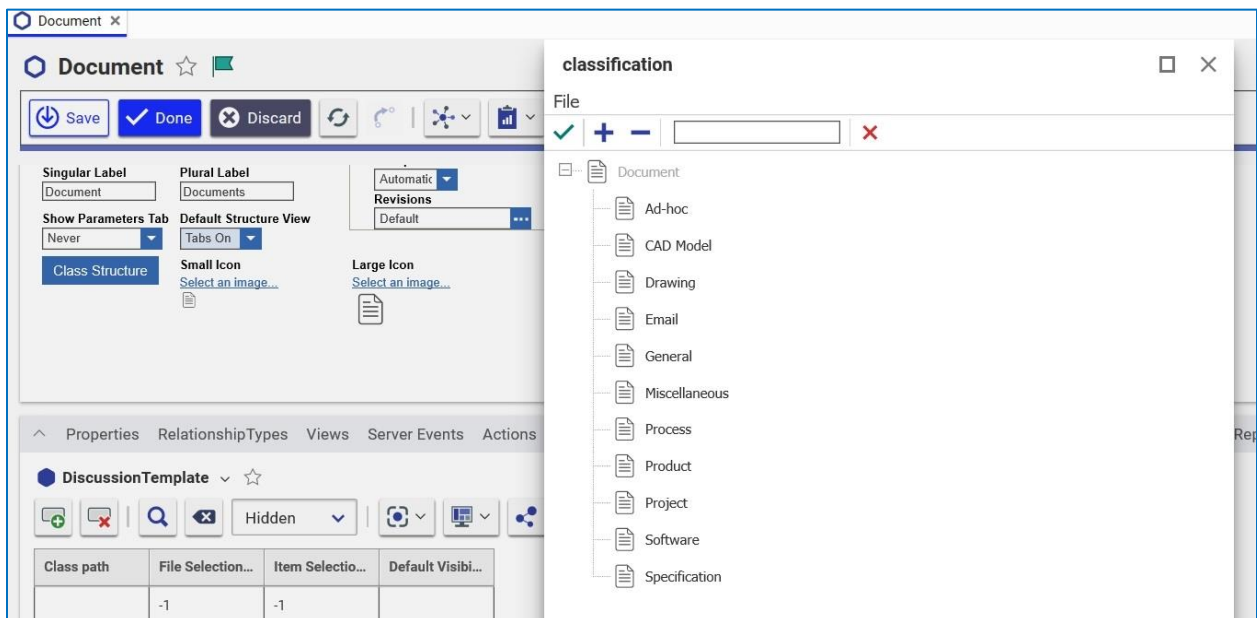
- Click the **New Discussion Template**  button in the Relationship toolbar to add a new DiscussionTemplate in the relationship grid.



The screenshot shows the 'Document' configuration page in Aras Innovator 33. The page has a top toolbar with buttons for Save, Done, Discard, and other actions. Below the toolbar, there are several sections for configuring the 'Document' item type, including Name, Singular Label, Plural Label, Show Parameters Tab, Default Structure View, Versioning, Search, and Implementation Type. A 'New Discussion Template' button is visible in the top right corner of the toolbar.

Figure 4.

- Click the **Class Path** box and then click the **ellipses** to access the **classification** dialog box.



The screenshot shows the 'Document' configuration page with the 'classification' dialog box open. The dialog box displays a tree view of class paths, including Document, Ad-hoc, CAD Model, Drawing, Email, General, Miscellaneous, Process, Product, Project, Software, and Specification. The 'Document' class path is selected.

Figure 5.

- Highlight the appropriate class path and click  to select and add it to the new DiscussionTemplate.

- Right-click the **DiscussionTemplate** and select **Secure Social** --> **Open** from the context menu.

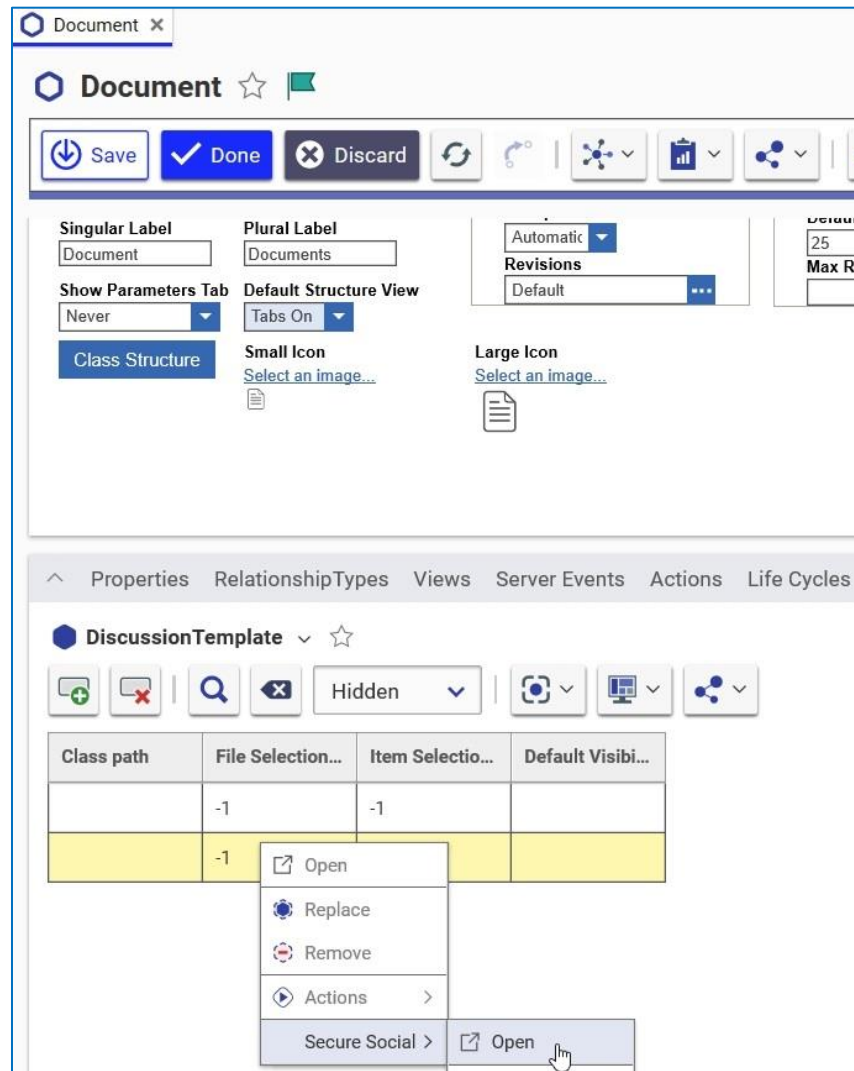


Figure 6.

This opens the item tear-off window for the **DiscussionTemplate**.

F4655C7CF70E... x

F4655C7CF70E46A2A3BBA841382554AD

☆

Edit

DiscussionTemplate

Class Path

File Selection Depth

-1

Item Selection Depth

-1

Default Visibility Identity

Message Visibility Supported

☒

Feed TemplateDiscussionTemplateView

FeedTemplate

☆

Hidden

Feed Type	History Events	Reference [...]	Polysource ty...
Board		this	

Figure 7.



- Click  to modify the properties provided in the **DiscussionTemplate** item tear-off window as required. Refer to Table 3 for the properties of the **DiscussionTemplate** along with its description.

Table 1: **DiscussionTemplate** properties

Property	Description
Class Path	(string: 512) Classification for which the DiscussionTemplate would serve as the default template (<code>is_default = true</code>). It is a single template for a particular classification.
File Selection Depth	(int; default: -1) This property defines the depth of the recursion in case of recursive message aggregation. The value “-1” means – no restriction.
Item Selection Depth	(int; default: -1) This property defines from how many levels of recursion to collect files for viewing in the UI in case of recursive message aggregation. The value “-1” means – no restriction.
Default Visibility Identity	(item: Identity) Identity to be used as the default shown in the Share with selector. A blank value means World . See section 7.1 for more details.
Message Visibility Supported	(boolean) if ON, the Share with selector is exposed in the Discussion Panel of any items of the given ItemType. If OFF, the selector is not exposed, and all messages are set to visibility = World . See section 7.1 for more details.
Feed Template Tab	The Feed Template tab defines Feeds and FileSelectors that are used for aggregating Secure Messages and History records for items of this type. For more information about the Feed Template, refer to FeedTemplate .
DiscussionTemplateView Tab	The DiscussionTemplateView Tab defines options to change the Secure Message template style. For more information about the DiscussionTemplateView , refer to DiscussionTemplateView .

4.2 FeedTemplate

A **Feed** is a function that returns a set of Secure Messages or History records associated with a set of items. Each **Feed** Item essentially represents a function.

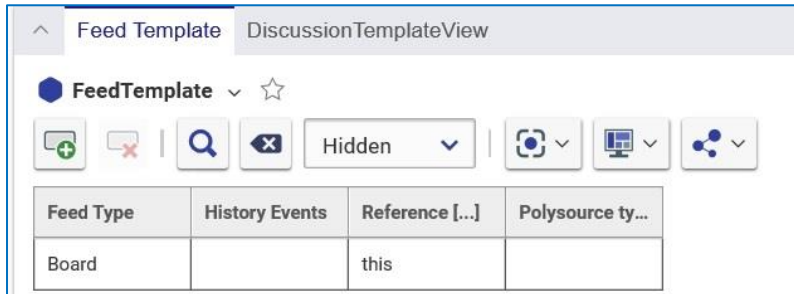


Figure 8.

A single **FeedTemplate** with the following default properties already appears in the Relationship grid:

- **Feed Type:** Board
- **History Events:** null
- **Reference:** this
- **Polysource type name:** null

Use the following procedure to make changes to the **FeedTemplate**:

1. Click  in the Relationship Toolbar to add a new FeedTemplate in the relationship grid.
2. Click the down arrow in the Feed Type column and select the appropriate Feed Type from the dropdown list.
3. Enter the appropriate Reference type in the Reference field.

4. Right-click the **FeedTemplate** in the Relationship grid and select **FeedTemplate --> Open** from the context menu. This opens the **FeedTemplate** Item tear-off window.

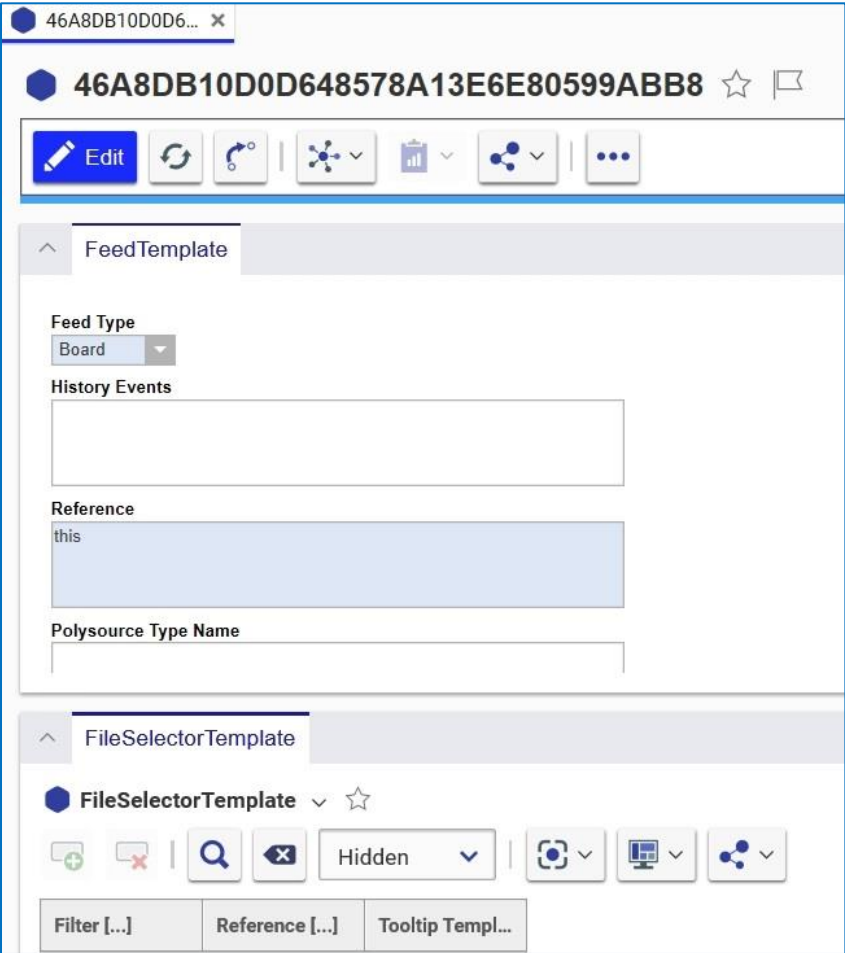


Figure 9.

5. Click  to modify the properties provided in the **FeedTemplate** as required. Refer to table 4 for the properties of the **FeedTemplate** along with its description.

Table 2: FeedTemplate Properties

Property	Description
Feed Type	There are two types of Feed: Board: if this Feed Type is selected; it means that the Secure Messages (and History records) will be aggregated from Boards of items that are referred by reference property. Discussion: if this Feed Type is selected, it means that for each item referenced by reference property, Aras Innovator executes all Feeds for the Item's DiscussionTemplate. It allows performing recursive aggregation of Secure Messages and History records from a hierarchical structure of items.
History Events	(string:512) This property is used to aggregate History actions on an item together with the Secure messages. The syntax of History Events is (" ") separated by a list of Configurable History Events. For example, "Add Update Promote" If the property value is "*" (asterisk wildcard) then all history records are aggregated. If the property value is blank, then no history records are aggregated. The property cannot be set for Feeds of Type Discussion.
Reference	(text) This property is used to aggregate secure messages depending on the Reference property of an Item. The syntax of the reference is: reference = this property relationshipPath(property) AML property = Name of the property of type Item. relationshipPath - relationshipName relationshipName/relationshipPath relationshipName - Name of a Relationship Type AML = {valid AML with single top level Item that has action="get" {custom method}}} Following are examples of few valid references: this p1 R1(p1) R1/R2/R3/R4(p1) <Item type="CAD" id="..." action="get" />
Polysource type name	This defines from what specific polysource type the Feed must aggregate Secure Messages. This property is set only when the reference of the Feed refers to a polyitem (For example, a Feed on the DiscussionTemplate for an ItemType Project has the reference=Project Docs(related_id) which references the deliverable which is a polyitem with out-of-the-box polysource Document). Defining a polysource is essential in case the Feed has at least one FileSelector, as a different polysource of the same Polymorphic itemtype can have different properties of type item with the data source file in their structure.
FileSelectorTemplate Tab	Selecting this tab displays a FileSelectorTemplate .

4.3 FileSelectorTemplate

VC has the capability to associate one or more FileTypes with an item to allow an end user to view files using the appropriate file viewer.

This is a template for creating **FileSelector** relationships when **Feed** is created based on a **FeedTemplate**.

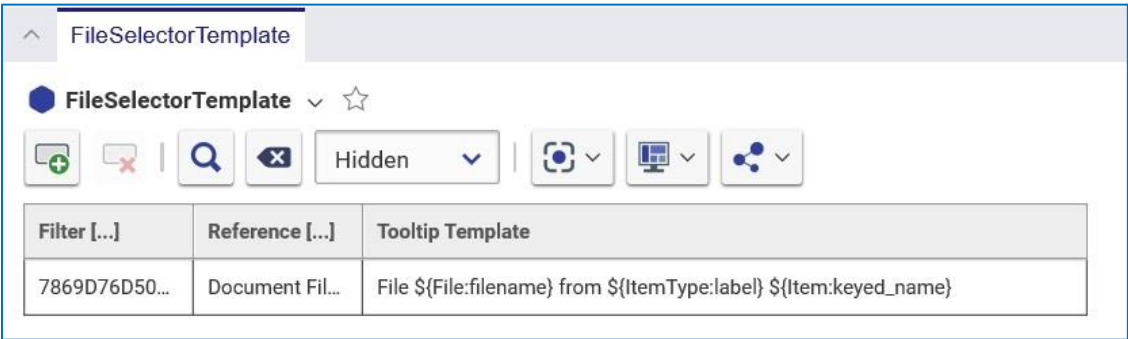


Figure 10.

In the case of the Document ItemType as shown here, a single **FileSelectorTemplate** with default properties is already added in the Relationship grid:

- Filter [...]
- Reference [...]
- Tooltip Template

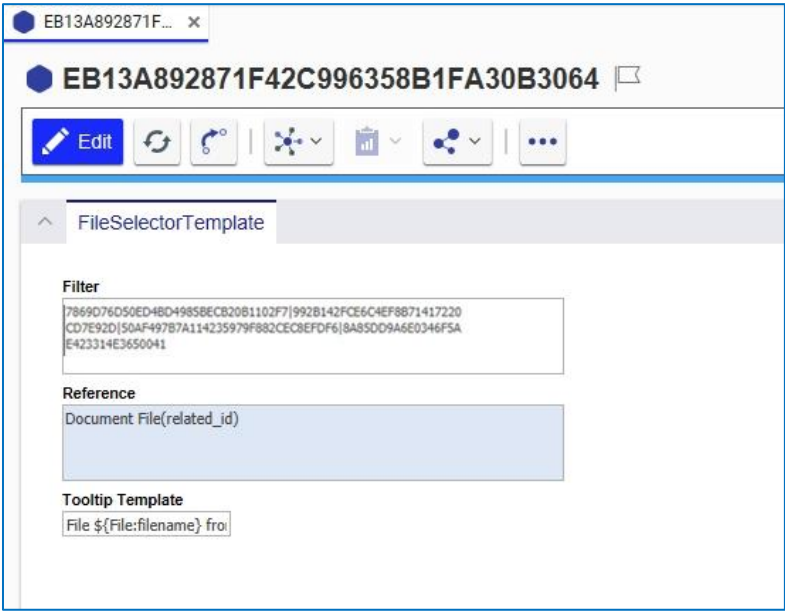


Figure 11.

Use the following procedure to make changes to the **FileSelectorTemplate**:

1. Click  in the **FeedTemplate** page.
2. Click  in the **FileSelectorTemplate** Relationship Toolbar to add a new **FileSelectorTemplate** in the relationship grid.
3. Right-click the **FileSelectorTemplate** in the Relationship grid and select **FileSelectorTemplate --> Open** in the context menu.
This opens the **FileSelectorTemplate** Item tear-off window.
4. Modify the properties of the **FileSelectorTemplate** as required. Refer to Table 5 for the properties of the **FileSelectorTemplate** along with its description.

Table 3: FileSelectorTemplate properties

Property	Description
Filter	(text) This allows selecting required files based on their FileType(s) and filter out files of undesired types. It is indicated by “ ” separated by a list of FileType Ids. If the property is not set, then Files of any types from which there is appropriate Viewer built-in can be selected. Lists of FileTypes already assigned to standard Innovator ItemTypes are shown in Appendix A.
Reference	(text) This property is used to select the files selected by appropriate <i>FeedTemplate</i>. The required files are selected from its own item files that belong to its relationships. The syntax of the reference is: reference = property relationshipPath(property) property = Name of property of type Item relationshipPath = relationshipName relationshipName/relationshipPath relationshipName = Name of a Relationship Type Following are few examples of valid References: p1 R1 (p1) R1/R2/R3/R4 (p1)
Tooltip Template	(string:128) It is a template for the tooltip. This tooltip is displayed when the user points the mouse over the appropriate file aggregated on sidebar. The tooltip template consists of a parameterized syntax with attribute or property name in it. For instance: File \${File:filename} from \${ItemType:label} \${Item:keyed_name} – This template is used to display the keyed name of the "markup" holder item.

4.4 DiscussionTemplateView

The **DiscussionTemplateView** tab defines the secure message template styles and tooltip templates for the secure messages.

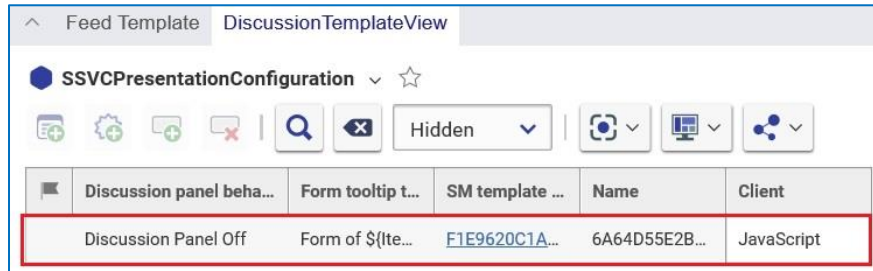


Figure 12.

One **DiscussionTemplateView** with default properties is added to the Relationship grid:

- Discussion panel behavior
- Form tooltip template
- SM template
- Name
- Client ("View Client" list)

To make configurations to the **DiscussionTemplateView**, do the following:



1. Click  in the Relationship Toolbar to add a new **DiscussionTemplateView** in the relationship grid.
2. Right-click on the **DiscussionTemplateView** in the Relationship grid and select **View SSVCPresentationConfiguration** from the context menu.
3. This opens the **SSVCPresentationConfiguration** Item tear-off window.

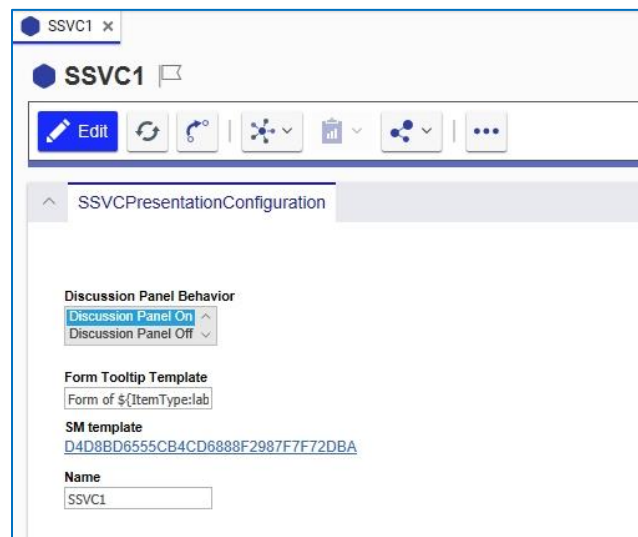


Figure 13.

4. Modify the properties provided in the **SSVCPresentationConfiguration** as required. Refer to Table 6 for the properties of the **SSVCPresentationConfiguration** along with its description.

Table 4: **SSVCPresentationConfiguration** properties

Property	Description
Discussion Panel Behavior	This indicates the default behavior of the discussion panel. This indicates whether the Discussion Panel is automatically displayed or not when the user opens the tear-off window
Form Tooltip Template	(string:128) It is a template for the tooltip of the Item's Form. The tooltip template consists of a parameterized syntax with the attribute or property name in it. For instance: • <i>"\${ItemType:label} \${Item:keyed_name}"</i> where <i>keyed_name</i> is property. This is the default value specified. • <i>"Form of \${@id}"</i> where <i>id</i> is an attribute.
SM Template	This gives a reference to the Secure Message Template used to display Secure Messages in the Discussion Panel. For more information, refer to SecureMessageViewTemplate .

4.5 SecureMessageViewTemplate

This template defines the style and template used to display the Secure Messages in the discussion panel.

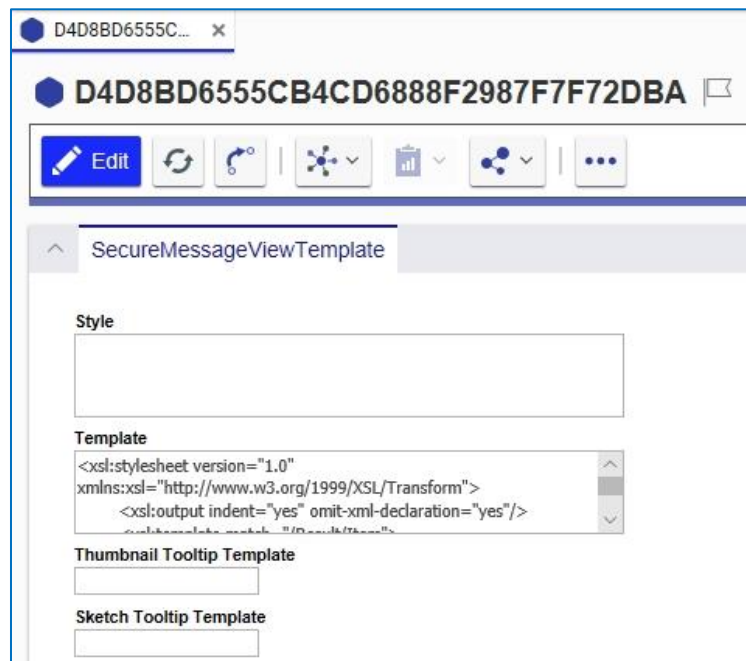


Figure 14.

Modify the properties provided in the **SecureMessageViewTemplate** as required. Refer to Table 7 for the properties of the **SecureMessageViewTemplate** along with its description.

Table 5: **SecureMessageViewTemplate** properties

Property	Description
Style	(text) This indicates the specific styling of the client. For example, CSS or XAML.
Template	(text) This is a template that is responsible for creating Secure Messages "mark-out". For example, JS or XAML.
Thumbnail Tooltip Template	(ml_string:128) This is a template for the thumbnail tooltip shown in the secure message. The tooltip template consists of a parameterized syntax with the following attribute/parameters in it: - o "markup holder" item - o file from which thumbnail was made - o the <i>SecureMessageMarkup</i> itself - o data from the <i>SecureMessageMarkup.markup_data</i> For instance: File \${File:filename} \${SecureMessageMarkup:markup_data(//page)} from \${Item:@type} \${Item:keyed_name}

Note: Because of difference between Windows and Linux file systems it is required to use OS-specific path separator in paths. Remember that Linux file system is case sensitive so file names `"/path/to/file.xml"` and `"/path/to/File.xml"` are different. For more information about cross-platform development please see section 2.3 *Cross-platform development* in *Aras Innovator 33 - Programmer's Guide* document.

4.6 Individual DiscussionDefinition

An administrator can configure the **DiscussionDefinition** of an individual item that is based on the **DiscussionTemplate**. This is used when a user (administrator) explicitly expressed a desire to change how the Secure Messages are aggregated for that item. In case the user wants to change at least one of *Feeds* that is associated with the **DiscussionTemplate** for this item. Thus, two items of the same *ItemType* can have discussions that are differently defined.

To change the settings in the individual item using **DiscussionDefinition**, do the following:

1. Open an instance of an item that has been enabled for Secure Social.

2. Click on **Actions** from the Item toolbar and select **Change Discussion Definition**.

Coupe

Coupe

☆

Part

Part Number

Coupe

Revision

A

State

Preliminary

Name

Coupe

Type

Assembly

Unit

EA

Make / Buy

Make

Cost

Long Description

Changes Pending

Create New Part

Properties

Permissions

Delete

PE: rollup all parts in DB

Manual Release

Create New Revision

Add Item(s) To Change...

Change Discussion Definition

Add Item to Bookmarks...

BOM

BOM Structure

Alternates

AML

Documents

CAD Documents

Goals

Changes

MyBOM

Parts

Hidden

Seq...	Part Number	Revi...	Name	Type	Quantity	State	Unit
1	Automatic Gearbox	A	Automatic Gearbox	Component	1	Preliminary	EA
2	Hybrid Engine	A	Hybrid Engine	Component	1	Preliminary	EA

Figure 15.

This opens the **DiscussionDefinition** item tear-off window.

Feed Type	History Events	Reference [...]	Polysource Ty...
Board		this	
Discussion		Part CAD(related...	
Discussion		Part Document(r...	
Discussion		Part BOM(related...	

Figure 16.

3. Modify the properties of the **Feed** tab to have multiple feeds used to aggregate secure messages in the discussion panel. For more information about the configurations that can be made in the **Feed** tab, refer to [FeedTemplate](#).
4. Modify the properties of the **DiscussionDefinitionView** tab to change the style, template and behavior of the Discussion Panel. For more information about the configurations that can be made in the **DiscussionDefinitionView** tab, refer to [DiscussionTemplateView](#).
5. Click  **Save** and  **Done** to close the window.

5 Display and Styling Control

The administrator can configure how the different aspects of the standard Visual Collaboration User Interface can be displayed.

5.1 Change the Secure Message Template Style

To change the Secure Message Template Style, do the following:

1. Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
2. Go to Contents --> **Administration** --> **ItemTypes**.
3. Run the search and open a secure social enabled ItemType for edit, for example, **Document**.
4. In the ItemType window, select the **Secure Social** tab.
5. Right-click the **DiscussionTemplate** in the Relationship grid and select **Secure Social** --> **Open** in the context menu.
6. In the **DiscussionTemplate** item tear-off window, click the **DiscussionTemplateView** tab.
7. Click the **ItemType ID** in **SM template** property.

Note: Because of difference between Windows and Linux file systems it is required to use OS-specific path separator in paths. Remember that Linux file system is case sensitive so file names **./path/to/file.xml** and **./path/to/File.xml** are different. For more information about cross-platform development please see section 2.3 *Cross-platform development* in the *Aras Innovator 33 - Programmer's Guide* document.

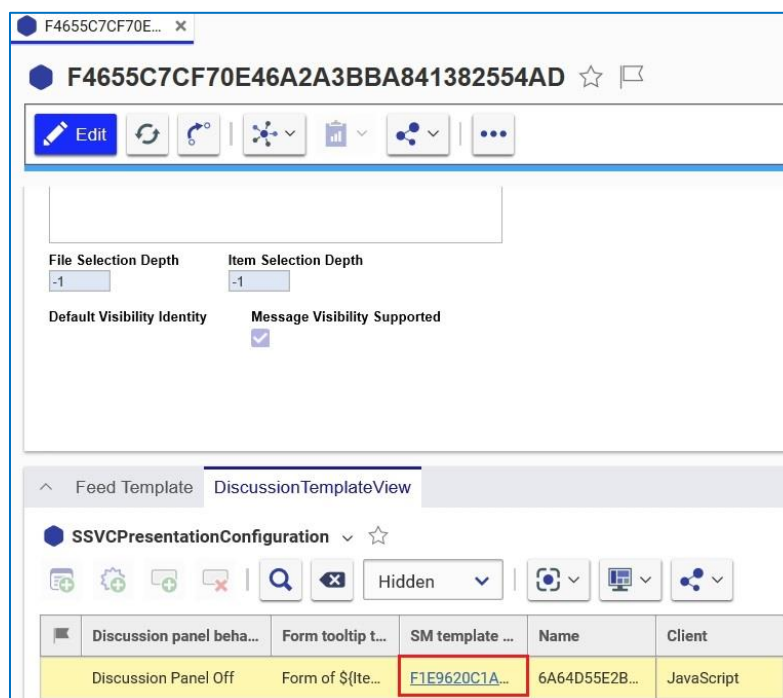


Figure 17.

This opens the **SecureMessageViewTemplate** Item tear-off window.

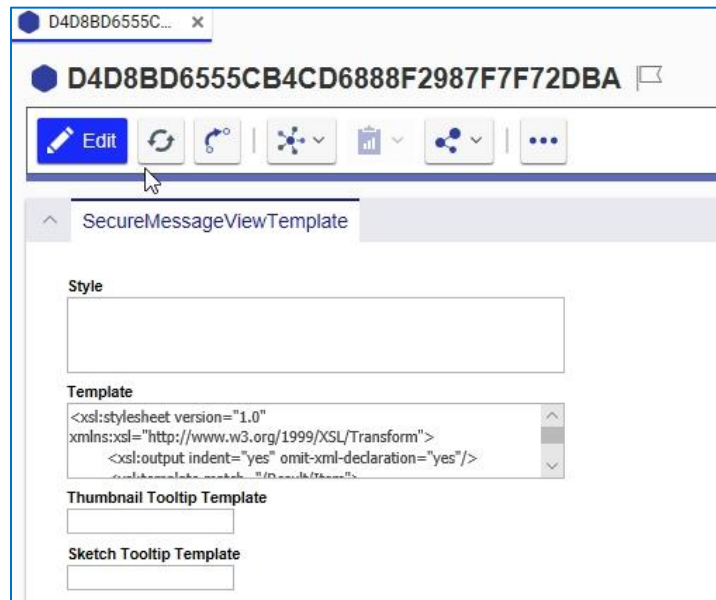


Figure 18.

8. In the **Template** field, for example, replace string:

```
<div id="messageText" class="ssvc-message-text">
```

with

```
<div id="messageText" class="ssvc-message-text" style="color:red"; ">
```

Note: Comment editing is currently unsupported in modified templates. It is only supported in the default SecureMessageViewTemplate.

9. Save, Unclaim and Close the windows.

Note: The described subsequence of steps will result in applying change in the style of displaying secure messages for all the ItemTypes from which modified item of SecureMessageViewTemplate is referenced from. In Order to apply change to items of one specific type only – new item of SecureMessageViewTemplate should be created (modified, as desired) and referenced from mentioned itemtype (DiscussionTemplate→DiscussionTemplateView→SM template [...]).

5.2 Set Sidebar Color for ItemType

The admin can set a color that is used for the vertical sidebar in the item tear-off window, as well as the vertical stripes shown on the right of all comments in the Discussion Panel. This color helps users to identify the type of item they are looking at on the screen. For standard ItemTypes the colors are set to be like the color of the ItemType's icon (e.g., Part is set to purple).

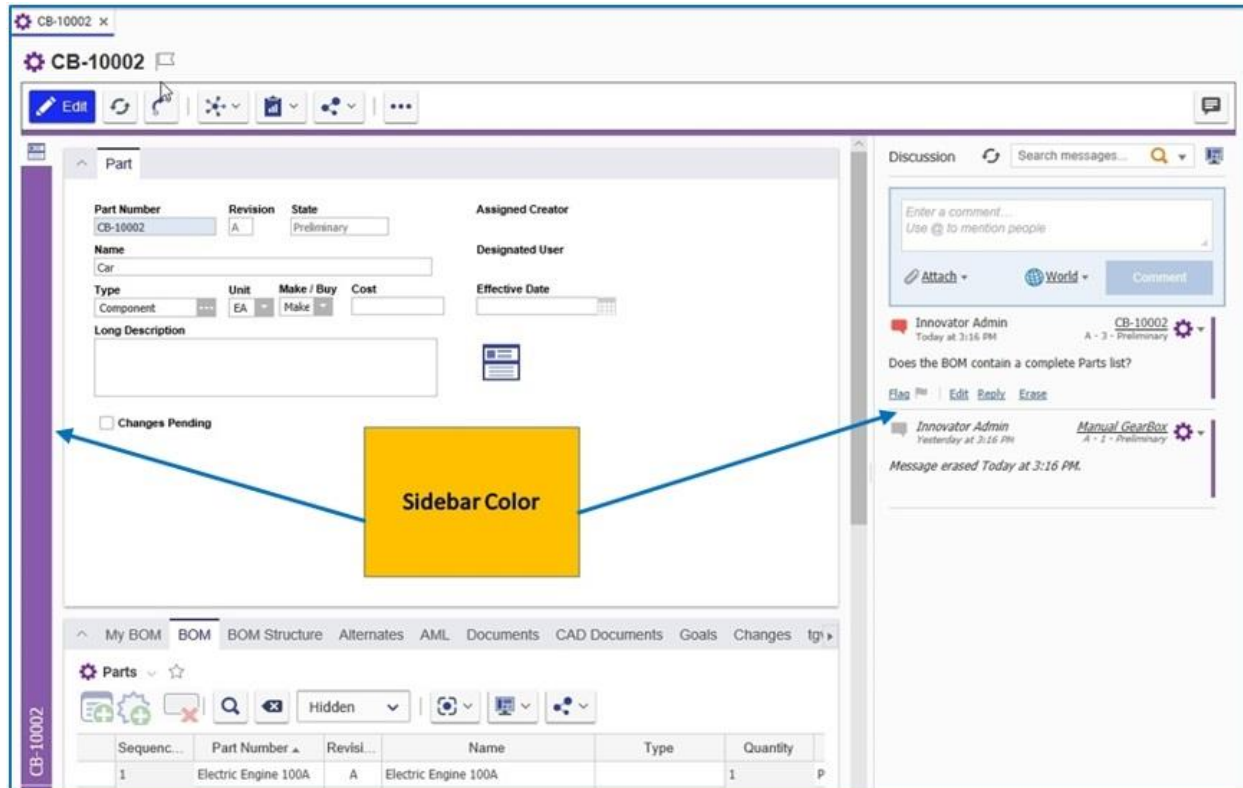


Figure 19.

To set the sidebar color for an ItemType, do the following:

1. Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
2. Go to Contents --> **Administration** --> **ItemTypes**.
3. Run the search and open a secure social enabled ItemType for edit.
4. In the ItemType window, select the **Client Style** tab.

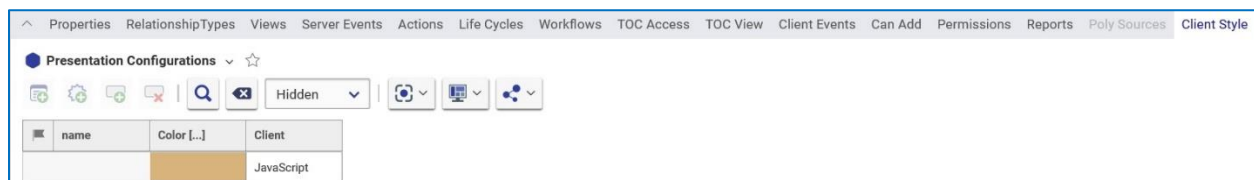


Figure 20.

For standard ItemTypes a single **PresentationConfiguration** template with default properties is listed in the Relationship grid:

- **name**
- **Color:** background-color: rgb(216, 179, 124);
- **Client:** JavaScript

5. Right-click the **PresentationConfiguration** in the Relationship grid and select **View PresentationConfiguration** in the context menu.

Use the following procedure to set the sidebar color for an ItemType:

1. Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
2. Go to **Contents --> Administration --> ItemTypes**. The menu shown in Figure 20 appears.

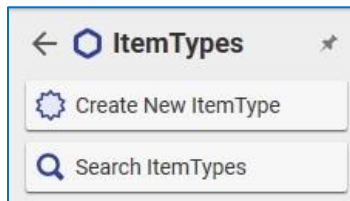


Figure 21.

3. Click **Search ItemTypes**. The Search Grid appears.
4. Open a secure social enabled ItemType for editing.
5. In the ItemType window, select the **Client Style** tab.

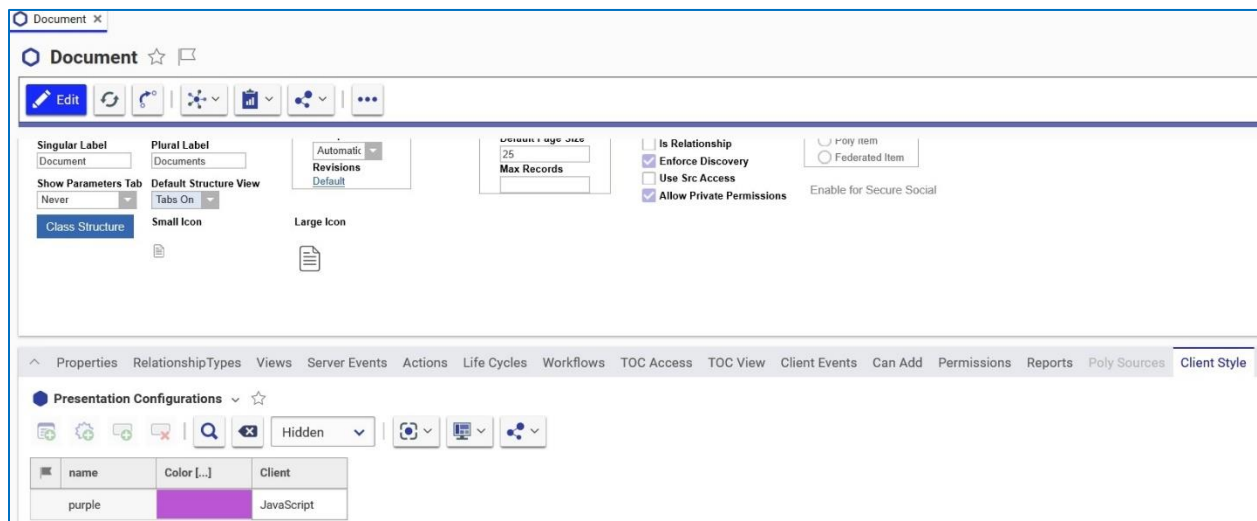


Figure 22.

- Right-click an entry in the name column and select **Open** in the context menu. This opens the **PresentationConfiguration** Item tear-off window.

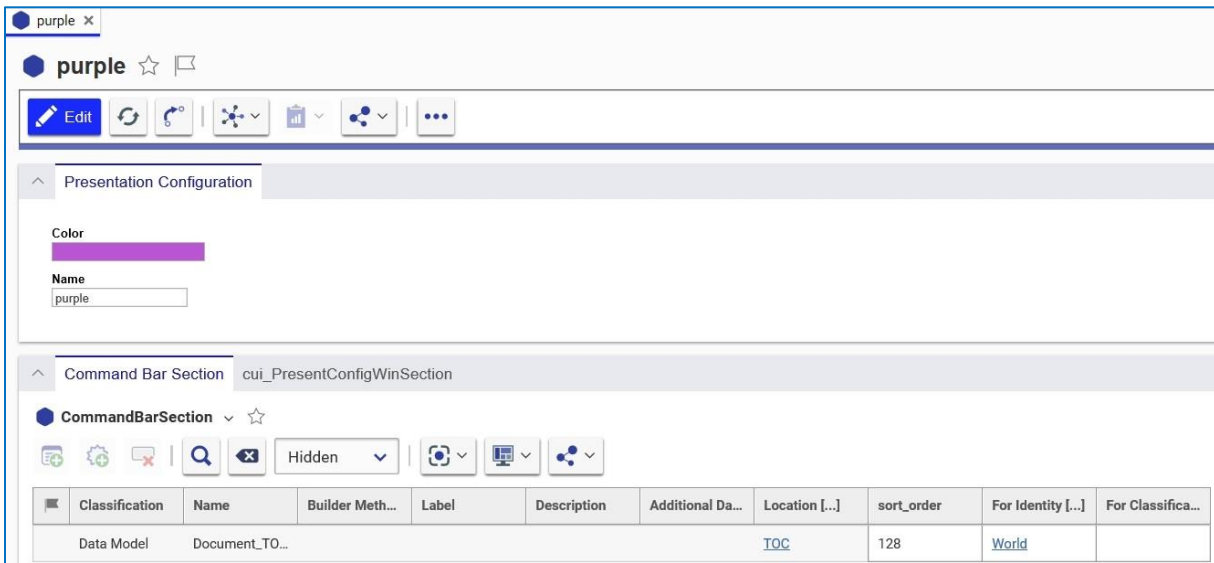


Figure 23.

- Modify the values of the **Style** field.

Note: This field is in CSS format. Either RGB or RGBA syntax is acceptable.

- Example of RGB syntax: background-color: rgb(2126, 179, 124);
- Example of RGBA syntax: background-color: rgba(0, 116, 198, 0.6);

- Click  and  to save and unclaim the items.

Note: The setting for “Secondary Icon” was used prior to Aras Innovator 11 SP5 to display an inverted (reverse color) icon in the sidebar and discussion panel but starting with 11 SP5 the styling has been changed so that this icon is no longer required.

5.3 Configure Form Tooltip Text

Tooltips are configurable by an administrator, by defining a parameterized string.

To configure the **Form** tooltip text, do the following:

- Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
- Go to Contents --> **Administration** --> **ItemTypes**.
- Open the **Document** ItemType for editing.
- Select the **Secure Social** tab.
- Right-click the **DiscussionTemplate** and click **Secure Social** --> **Open** in the context menu.

6. Click the **DiscussionTemplateView** tab.

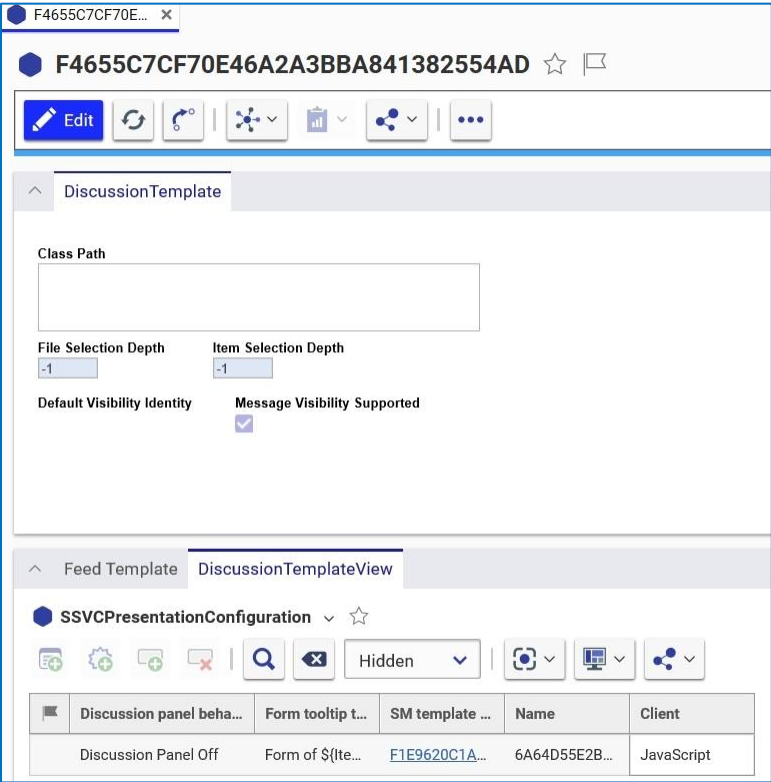


Figure 24.

7. Right-click the Relationship grid and select **Open** from the context menu.
This opens the **SSVCPresentationConfiguration** Item tear-off window.

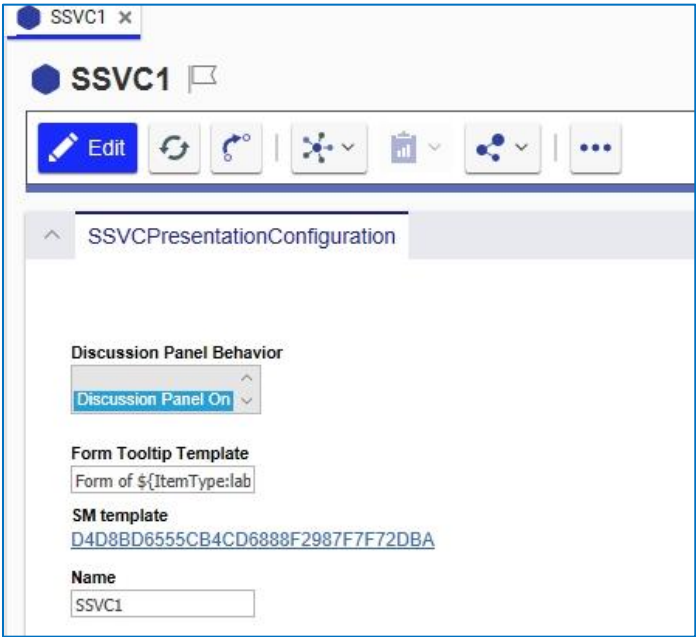


Figure 25.

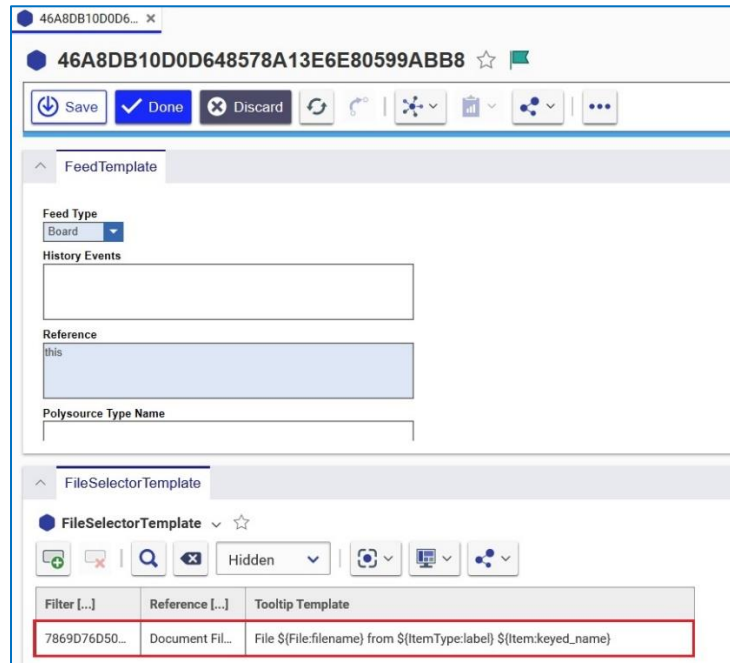
8. In the **Form of Tooltip Template** field, for example, replace the text from:
`Form of ${ItemType:label} ${Item:keyed_name}`
 to
`This is the form of ${ItemType:label} ${Item:keyed_name}`
9. Save, Unclaim and Close the windows.

5.4 Configure File Tooltip Text

Tooltips are configurable by an administrator, by defining a parameterized string.

To configure tooltip text for File Selector, do the following:

1. Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
 2. Go to Contents --> **Administration** --> **ItemTypes**.
 3. Open the **Document** ItemType for editing.
 4. Select the **Secure Social** tab.
 5. Right-click the **DiscussionTemplate** in the Relationship grid and click **Secure Social** --> **Open** from the context menu. The **DiscussionTemplate** tear-off window appears.
- 
6. Click  to unclaim the template.
 7. Click the **FeedTemplate** tab.
8. Click the **New FeedTemplate**  button in the Relationship Toolbar to add a new **FileSelectorTemplate** in the relationship grid.



The screenshot shows the Aras Innovator interface for editing a template. The top toolbar contains buttons for Save, Done, Discard, and other actions. The main area is divided into two tabs: FeedTemplate and FileSelectorTemplate. The FeedTemplate tab is active, showing fields for Feed Type (Board), History Events, Reference (this), and Polysource Type Name. The FileSelectorTemplate tab is also visible, showing a relationship grid with columns for Filter, Reference, and Tooltip Template. The grid contains one entry with the following values:

Filter [...]	Reference [...]	Tooltip Template
7869D76D50...	Document Fil...	File \$(File:filename) from \$(ItemType:label) \$(Item:keyed_name)

Figure 26.

Double-click the properties in the columns to modify them as required;

- Filter:** Input the file type ID
- Reference:** Input the file “related_id” value
- Tooltip Template:** Configure the Tooltip template, for example,

Replace:

File \${File:filename} from \${ItemType:label} \${Item:keyed_name}

To:

Test File \${File:testpdf} from \${ItemType:testssvc} \${Item:pdfdoc}

- Save, Unclaim and Close the windows.

Table 8 shows the configuration options and default settings.

Table 6: Configuration options and default settings

Type	Parameterization Options	Default Setting	Example
3D Viewer with single file	Label property of container ItemType Any property of the current Item Any property of the File Filename without extension, as a calculated value	“File “ <filename_no_ext> “ from “<itemtype label> “ “ <item keyed_name>	File StepStruder from CAD Document D-24811
PDF Viewer with single file	Label property of container ItemType Any property of the current Item Any property of the File Filename without extension, as a calculated value	“File “ <filename_no_ext> “ from “<itemtype label> “ “ <item keyed_name>	File Test Plan from Document D12345
Image Viewer with single file	Label property of container ItemType Any property of the current Item Any property of the File Filename without extension, as a calculated value	“File “ <filename_no_ext> “ from “<itemtype label> “ “ <item keyed_name>	File Image001 from Document D35135

5.5 Setting Visibility of Sidebar and Discussion Panel

The Visual Collaboration User Interface for an individual item tear-off window consists of a sidebar and a discussion panel. An admin can choose to display this interface for a specific ItemType, either overall or based on Identity or classification. Note that this is independent of whether the ItemType is enabled for Secure Social.

An admin can configure this setting by doing the following:

1. Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
2. Go to Contents --> **Administration** --> **ItemTypes**.
3. Open a secure social enabled ItemType, for example, **Document** ItemType for editing.
4. Go to the **Views** tab.

The screenshot shows the 'Document' ItemType configuration page in the 'Views' tab. The 'Form Name' is 'Document', 'Type' is 'Default', and 'Description' is 'World'. The 'Secure Social' property is checked. The 'Form Name' is 'Document', 'Type' is 'Default', and 'Description' is 'World'. The 'Secure Social' property is checked.

Form Name	Type	Description	Identity [...]	Classification	Display Priority	Secure Social
Document	Default		World			☒

Figure 27.

5. The **Secure Social** property in the relationship grid is enabled (set to 1) by default. This means that for the **Default** view type for a **Document** Item, the visual collaboration user interface is visible to an end user.

Note: For the remaining view types, this property is disabled (set to 0) by default.

6. Disable this property if you need to hide the visual collaboration interface for that specific view.
7. Save, Unclaim and close the window.

6 Notifications

An important feature of Visual Collaboration is the ability to notify users when they have new messages available to read. Notification is handled in two ways, directly within the Aras Innovator client, and through email.

6.1 Set up of Conversion Server and Agent Service

Notification capability requires the installation of the Aras Agent Service and the Conversion Server. See the *Conversion Server Setup Guide* and *Installation Guide* (for Agent Service) for details.

Once the Agent Service has been installed, you must configure the conversion.config file located within the AgentService folder. The following additions must be made to the file:

```
<ProcessingCycles>
  <cycle DB="database" User="user" Interval="20000" MaxBatch="5" />
  <cycle DB="database" User="user" Interval="20000" MaxBatch="1"
    ConversionRuleName="SSVC.Email.Digest.Notification.Rule" />
  <cycle DB="database" User="user" Interval="5000" MaxBatch="50"
    ConversionRuleName="SSVC.Notification.Rule" />
</ProcessingCycles>
```

Substitute the appropriate values for your environment for the items in blue.

Once these edits have been made, restart the Agent Service.

6.2 Enabling Notifications

There is a “master switch” available only to Administrators, which turns on (or off) the overall Visual Collaboration Notification mechanism. This is in the **Actions** menu as shown in Figure 27.

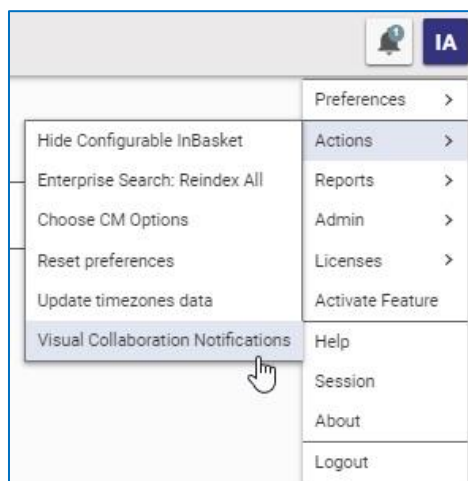
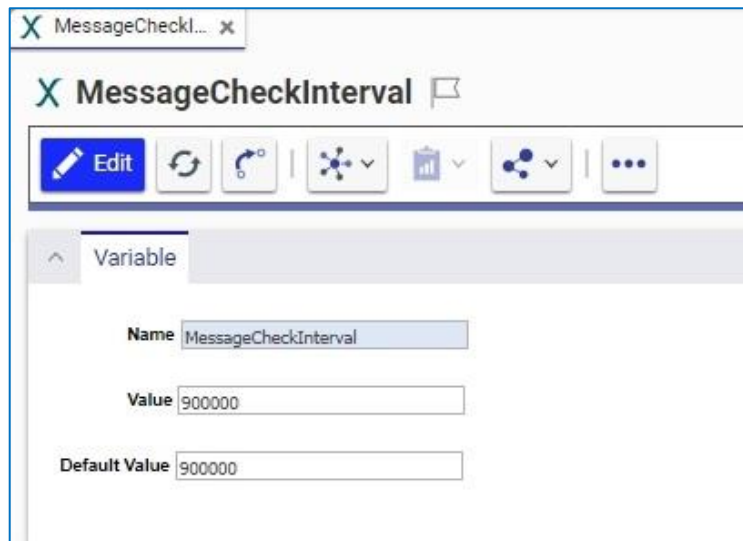


Figure 28.

6.3 Setting Polling Interval

The administrator can control the polling interval for notifications. This is set by a Variable named **MessageCheckInterval**. The value is set in milliseconds, with the default of 900000 (15 minutes).



The screenshot shows a window titled "MessageCheckInterval" with a toolbar containing buttons for Edit, Refresh, Undo, and other actions. Below the toolbar, the "Variable" tab is selected, showing the following fields:

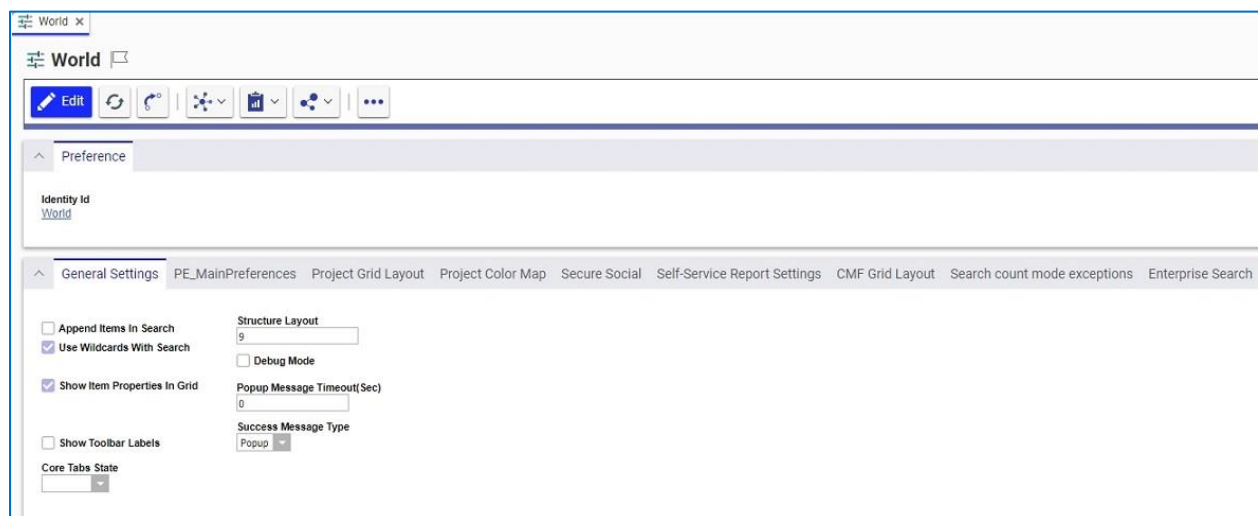
- Name:** MessageCheckInterval
- Value:** 900000
- Default Value:** 900000

Figure 29.

6.4 Notification Preferences

Preference settings for notifications are contained within the Secure Social tab of the Preferences ItemType. Options include:

- Notification within the web client
- Notification by email on every message
- Notification by email as a digest



The screenshot shows the "World" Preferences window with the "Secure Social" tab selected. The "General Settings" sub-tab is active, displaying various configuration options:

- ☐ Append Items In Search
- ☒ Use Wildcards With Search
- ☒ Show Item Properties In Grid
- ☐ Show Toolbar Labels
- Core Tabs State:** [Dropdown menu]
- Structure Layout:** 9
- ☐ Debug Mode
- Popup Message Timeout(Sec):** 0
- Success Message Type:** Popup

Figure 30.

By setting these values for the World identity, the administrator can set the default values for all users. Users do not access the Preferences ItemType directly.

6.5 Notifications in the Aras Web Client

When notifications are enabled and the user has selected the option to see notifications in the web client, the notifications will appear in the **Notifications** button of the Aras Innovator client.



Figure 31.

If the user clicks on the pop-up notification, they will be redirected to their My Discussions screen to see the new messages.

6.6 Configuration of Email Notifications

Use of email notifications requires the general setup of email capability within Aras Innovator. If you have any questions about setting up an email server with Aras Innovator, please contact Aras Support at support@aras.com.

Configuration of email notifications specifically for Visual Collaboration is done in the **Secure Social** tab of the **Preferences** ItemType for the **World** Identity.

The screenshot shows the 'Secure Social' tab in the 'Preferences' section for the 'World' identity. The 'Email Notifications' section is expanded, showing the following settings:

- Subject line for single notifications:** [Aras] Visual Collaboration Notification – new message
- Description text for single notifications:** The following new message has posted in your discussions:
- Subject line for digest notifications:** [Aras] Visual Collaboration Notification – new messages
- Description text for digest notifications:** The following new messages have posted in your discussions:
- Time interval for digest notifications (hours):** 24

The 'Message Notification' section includes the following settings:

- ☐ Use Standard Toolbar For Viewers
- ☐ Use Legacy 3D View Files
- Message Notification:**
 - ☒ Within the web client
 - ☒ Email on every message
 - ☒ Email digest
- Prefix Text For Highlight Text Markup:** Change to:

Figure 32.

Settings include:

- **Subject line for single notifications**
The text to display in the subject line for emails sent on a per-message basis
- **Description text for single notifications**
The text to display in the email message body for emails sent on a per-message basis
- **Subject line for digest notifications**
The text to display in the subject line for digest emails
- **Description text for digest notifications**
The text to display in the email message body for digest emails
- **Time interval for digest notifications (hours)**
The time interval (in hours) at which digest emails will be sent. Note that this interval must be the same for all users that have chosen to receive digest emails.

6.7 Result of Email Notifications

If users have enabled one or both types of email notification, and have an email address defined for them, they will receive emails that look as follows:

- Single emails

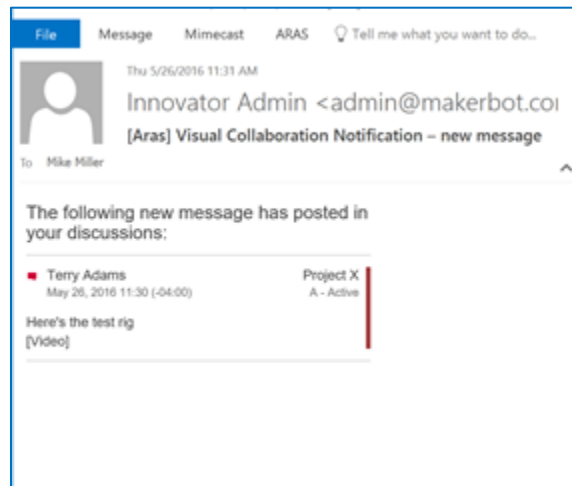


Figure 33.

- Digest emails

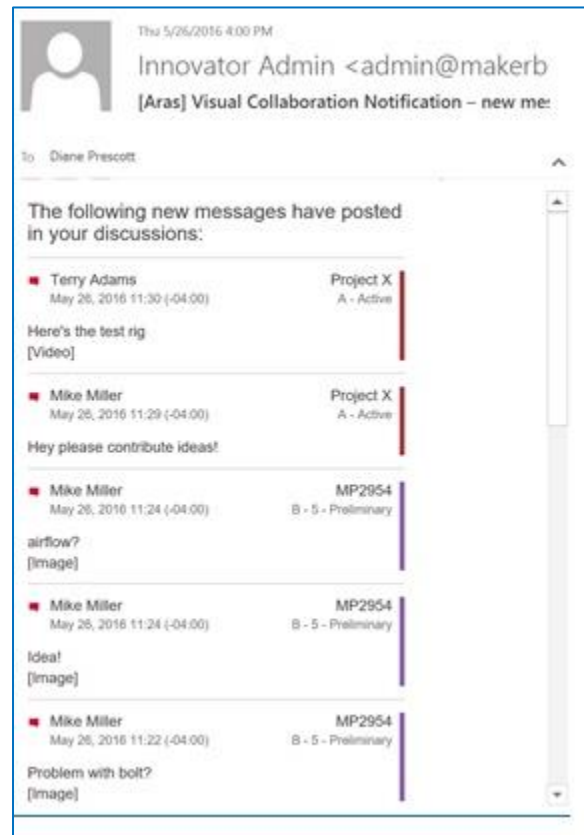


Figure 34.

Some details have been removed in the email content, compared to the corresponding live content in the web client, such as icons and thumbnails.

7 Message Visibility

By default, any user with the **Get** permissions to an item can see messages that have been posted on the Board of that item. However, it is sometimes desirable to restrict more tightly the visibility of messages on items. This can be achieved using message visibility control, also known as the **Share with** control. When this option is used, all users with the **Get** permissions to an item *and* who belong to the selected Identity will be able to see the message.

7.1 ItemType Configuration Options

The settings for the configuration of message visibility are found on **Discussion Template**, as described in full in section [4.1](#) above.

The screenshot shows the configuration interface for a Discussion Template in Aras Innovator 33. The interface is divided into two main sections: 'DiscussionTemplate' and 'Feed Template'.

DiscussionTemplate Section:

- Class Path:** A text input field.
- File Selection Depth:** A dropdown menu set to '-1'.
- Item Selection Depth:** A dropdown menu set to '-1'.
- Default Visibility Identity:** A text input field.
- Message Visibility Supported:** A checkbox that is checked.

Feed Template Section:

- FeedTemplate:** A dropdown menu set to 'FeedTemplate'.
- Hidden:** A dropdown menu set to 'Hidden'.
- Feed Type:** A dropdown menu set to 'Board'.
- History Events:** A text input field.
- Reference [...]:** A text input field set to 'this'.
- Polysource ty...:** A text input field.

Feed Type	History Events	Reference [...]	Polysource ty...
Board		this	

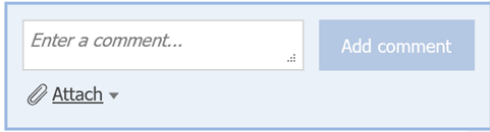
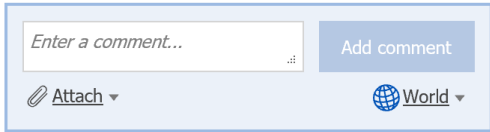
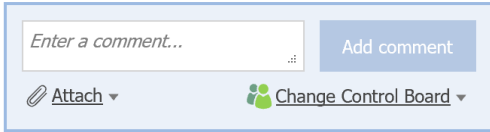
Figure 35.

Table 7: Discussion Template settings

Property	Description
Default Visibility Identity	(item: Identity) Identity to be used as the default shown in the Share with selector. A blank value means World .
Message Visibility Supported	(boolean) if ON, the Share with selector is exposed in the Discussion Panel of any items of the given ItemType. If OFF, the selector is not exposed, and all messages are set to visibility = World .

Based on these settings you can achieve the following behaviors for the **Share with** selector.

Table 8: **Share with** selector behaviors

Settings	Behavior
Message Visibility Supported = OFF	
Message Visibility Supported = ON Default Visibility Identity = (blank)	
Message Visibility Supported = ON Default Visibility Identity = Change Control Board	

The point of the **Default Visibility** Identity is to provide a way to restrict messages by default to a smaller subset of users, rather than forcing the user posting the message to always must remember to set something other than **World**.

7.2 Identity Selection

When the **Share with** selector is enabled, users will be able to select any available Identity to share the message with. This can be an alias identity (person) or non-alias identity (group). The following identities are not available for the user to select:

- System identities (Team identities, Forum Reader, etc.)
- The user's own identity (Sharing a message with oneself is not supported)

When the user initially picks the selector, a list of certain pre-set options will be available, as shown in Figure 35.

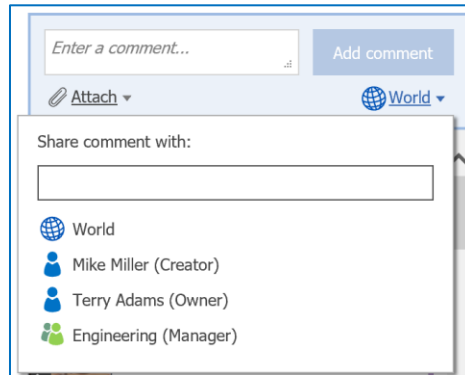


Figure 36.

This list will include:

- **World**
- The item's **Creator** (created_by_id)
- The item's current **Owner** (owned_by_id), if set
- The item's current **Manager** (managed_by_id), if set
- The ItemType's default visibility identity if set

These presets just make it easier to pick some of the common identities that may be used in typical messaging situations. Note that if assignments of **Owner** or **Manager** change later, it does not change the visibility of already-created messages (all messages are set to a specific Identity at time of creation).

If the user starts to type a name, the system will display matching Identity names. At any point the user can pick the desired Identity name.

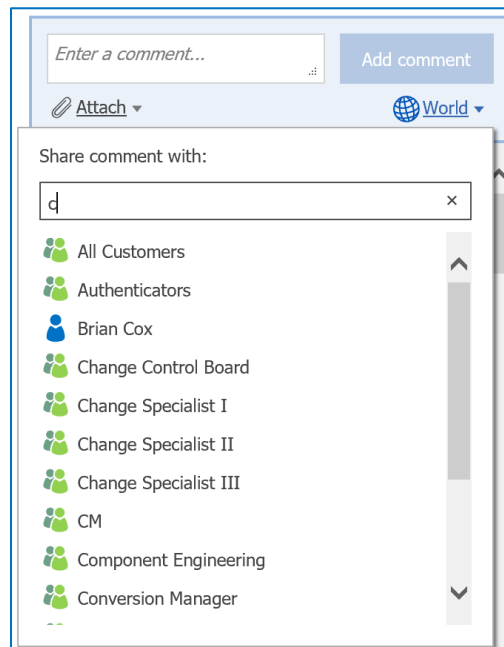


Figure 37.

7.3 Display of Posted Messages

When a message is posted with the **Share with** Identity set to something other than **World**, an icon will be displayed in the lower-left corner of the message. By hovering over this icon, a tooltip will appear which shows the shared-with identity, as shown here:

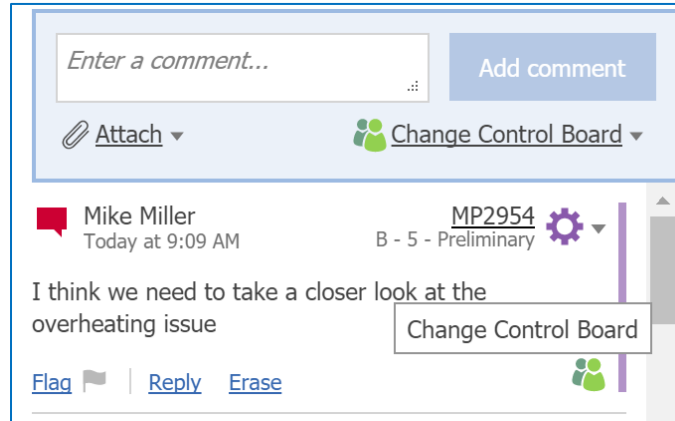


Figure 38.

For Reply messages, the tooltip will show both the original sender and the **Share with** Identity.

Note: The original sender of a message may or may not be part of a group identity that a message is sent to. Users should be aware that all Reply messages are visible both to the original sender and the group the message was sent to.

7.4 Special Handling for Private Messages

When message visibility is set to an alias Identity (a single person), special handling is used to make sure that the recipient will be able to see this "private message". Display of messages in a user's "My Discussions" window is based on whether the user is following either the sender of the message, or the item the message is posted on, in his Bookmarks. Notification is in turn based upon what messages appear in the user's "My Discussions" window. So, if the "recipient" of a private message is not following the sender or the item in his Bookmarks, he would not see the message in his My Discussion window. To avoid this issue, the system automatically adds the message to the user's My Discussion window, within the bookmark "My Messages". This means also that the message will be included in any notifications.

Messages where the "Share with" Identity is set to a group (non-alias Identity) do not have any such special handling.

8 Managing Forums

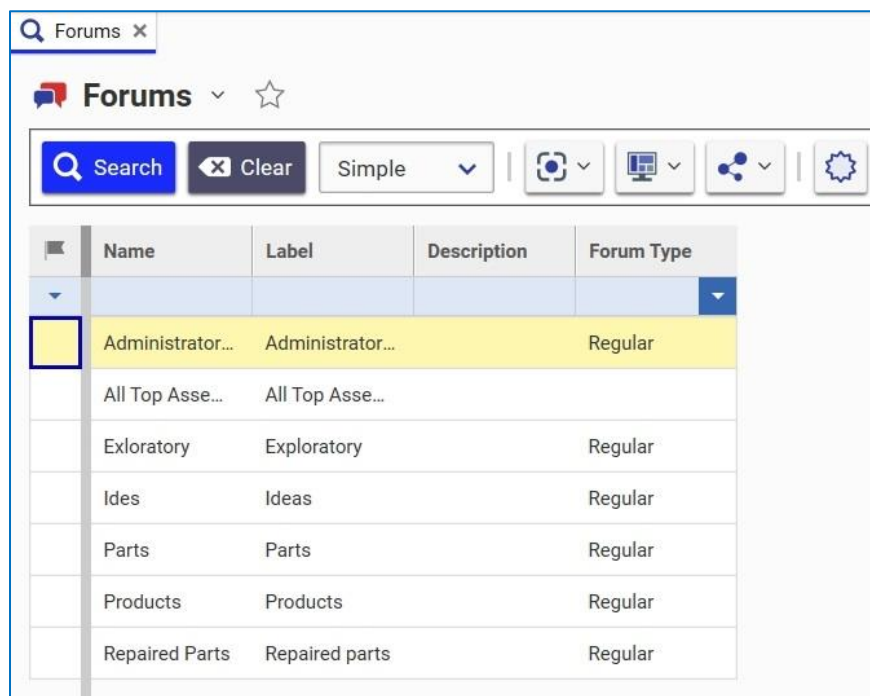
Forums are items that users interact within only from within the My Discussions window. They provide a way to have a general discussion topic and can aggregate discussion content from items and saved searches contained within them. End user functionality for Forums exists within My Discussions, and in the “Add Item(s) to Bookmarks” action. Special administrator-only capabilities for Forums are described in this section.

8.1 Force Users to Follow Forums

Administrators have access to Forums in the Aras Innovator section of the TOC. Administrators can force other users to follow forums from here. The reason for forcing users to follow Forums is to make sure that some or all users within an environment have the same discussion topics available to them.

An admin can force a forum to reside on a user’s bookmarks by doing the following:

1. Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
2. Go to Contents --> **Administration** --> **Secure Social** --> **Forums**.
3. Run a search to see all the forums created by the users.



	Name	Label	Description	Forum Type
	Administrator...	Administrator...		Regular
	All Top Asse...	All Top Asse...		
	Exploratory	Exploratory		Regular
	Ideas	Ideas		Regular
	Parts	Parts		Regular
	Products	Products		Regular
	Repaired Parts	Repaired parts		Regular

Figure 39.

- Right-click and open the required **Forum** for editing.

Note: The selected forum should be the **Regular** forum type.

The screenshot shows the 'Interesting Stuff' forum configuration page. The top section has a tab 'Interesting Stuff' and a toolbar with buttons for Edit, Refresh, Link, Share, and others. Below the toolbar is a 'Forum' section with fields for Name (Interesting Stuff), Label (Interesting Stuff), Description, and Forum Type (Regular). At the bottom, there is a 'ForumItems' section with a toolbar and a table with columns: Item Type, Item Config Id, Item Keyed N..., and Is Board Only.

Figure 40.

- Select the **Must View By** tab and then click the  button in the Relationship toolbar.

6. Add the required Identities to the **must_view_id** property.

The screenshot displays the 'Interesting Stuff' forum configuration window. The window has a title bar with a close button and the text 'Interesting Stuff'. Below the title bar is a toolbar with icons for Edit, Refresh, Undo, Redo, and a menu icon. The main content area is divided into two sections. The top section is labeled 'Forum' and contains fields for Name (Interesting Stuff), Label (Interesting Stuff), Description, and Forum Type (Regular). The bottom section is labeled 'Must View By' and contains a dropdown menu for 'ForumMustViewBy' (set to 'Hidden') and a text input field for 'must_view_id...' with the value 'Manufacturing'.

Figure 41.

7. Click **Done** to save and unlock the window.

8.2 Set a Forum to Inactive

The administrator can set a Forum to an inactive state. The admin can do this by using the **Promote** button on the Item toolbar.

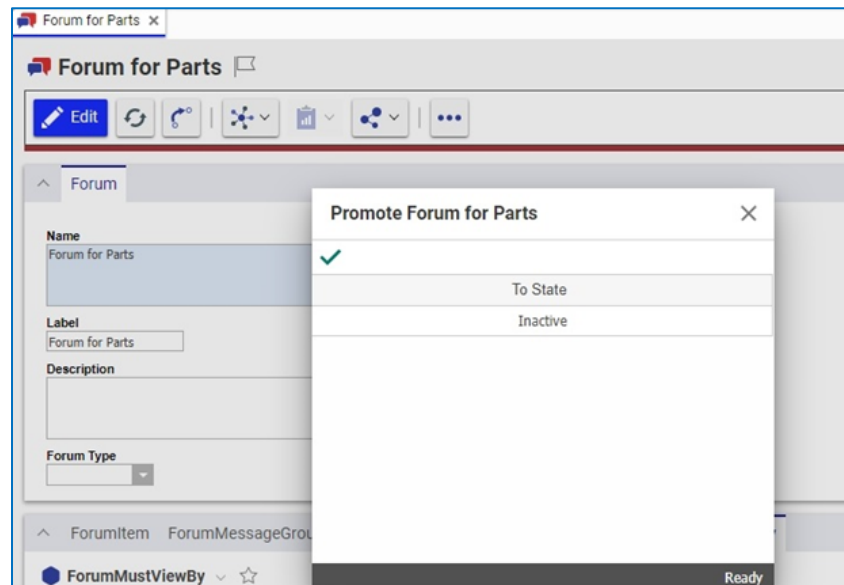


Figure 42.

When a Forum is in an inactive state, it automatically disappears from any user's Bookmarks. It is also not visible within the Follow Forum selector.

8.3 Delete a Forum

The administrator can delete a Forum. The admin can do this by clicking  in the toolbar and selecting **Delete --> Delete** from the drop-down menu.

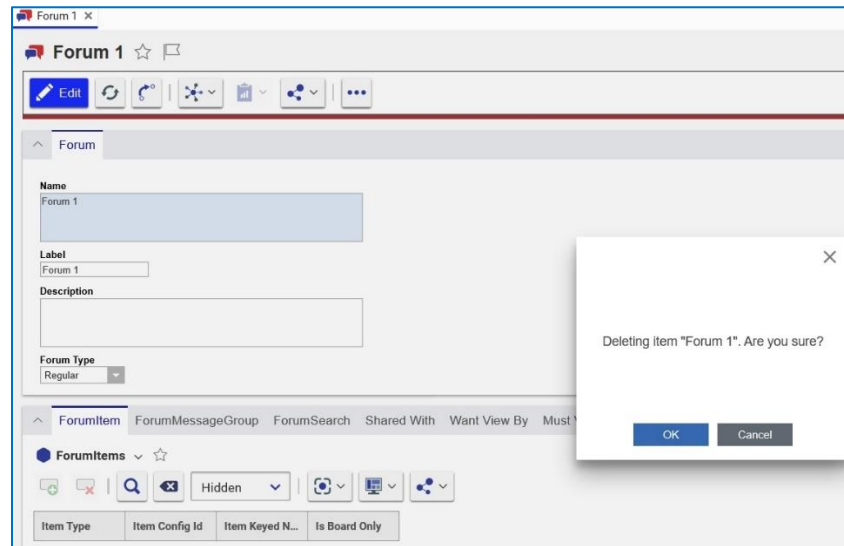


Figure 43.

When a Forum is deleted by an admin, it is automatically deleted from any user's Bookmarks without giving any warning to the user.

9 Viewer Configuration

Visual Collaboration supports viewing of file content in a variety of common formats. Different viewers with capabilities uniquely suited to the different file formats are provided. Options for configuring the behavior of the viewers are described in this section.

9.1 Available Viewers

Aras Innovator provides five different viewers, depending on the type of file being viewed. Viewers are accessed from the sidebar of the item window. The following configuration steps are necessary for files to be accessible on the sidebar:

- The ItemType must be enabled for Secure Social (see section [3](#))
- A FileSelectorTemplate must be defined, and set to include in the IDs of desired FileTypes in the *Filter* property (see section [4.3](#))
- A file with the specific FileType must be added to the Item at the *Reference* location as specified on the FileSelectorTemplate

Table 11 describes the viewers that are provided and support the listed FileTypes.

Table 9: Provided viewers

Sidebar Display	Viewer	FileType(s)	Extension(s)
	3D	HOOPS Stream Cache Single Model	scs
	PDF	PDF Document	pdf
	Image	JPEG Image	jpg,jpeg
		PNG Image	png
		GIF Image	gif
	Advanced Image	TIFF Image	tif,tiff
		BMP Image	bmp
	Comparison	Special viewer created dynamically when using the Compare function on PDF or Advanced Image files	
	Simulation	wCAX VCollab WEB	wcax

Any of the discussed FileTypes can be supported for viewing on any Aras Innovator ItemType, given the proper configuration.

Note: Standard Aras ItemTypes are not currently configured to display the TIFF and BMP files. Administrators must configure ItemTypes to include these FileTypes if desired, using the instructions in section [4.3](#)

9.2 Converting and Viewing 3D CAD Files

The use of the 3D viewer requires conversion of native 3D CAD models to the format used by the viewer (hvf). This is done using the Aras 3D CAD to PDF Converter, which runs inside the Aras Conversion Server. This converter takes any standard native 3D CAD files as input and runs a conversion process in the background. In the typical case, these input native 3D CAD files are coming from an Aras CAD Connector.

Note: For more information on the CAD to PDF Conversion Server, refer to the topic *Configuring the Conversion Server* from the *Aras 3D Visualization - CAD to PDF Converter Setup Guide* document.

By default, the Aras 3D CAD to PDF Converter will produce as output the following set of files, which will be set to the listed properties on the **CAD Document** item.

Table 10: Supported FileTypes

FileType	Extension	CAD Property	Purpose
HOOPS Stream Cache Single Model	scs	native_file > fr_representation > fr_representation_file > related_file	Viewing within Aras Visual Collaboration
PNG Image	png	thumbnail	Thumbnail image
3D PDF Document	pdf	viewable_file	Viewing within Adobe Reader
PRC Model	prc	monolithic_model_file	Neutral 3D representation

Note: For more information on the CAD data model and file representations, refer to the *CAD Data Model* section in the *Aras 3D Visualization - Administrator Guide*.

Note that unlike the Aras PDF viewer, the 3D viewer does not view the 3D PDF file directly. The 3D PDF file is made available for other purposes, such as sending outside the company to those without direct access to Aras Innovator, for viewing in Adobe Reader. If the requirement is just to view 3D inside Aras Visual Collaboration, the generation of the 3D PDF file can be disabled. See the **Aras 3D Visualization CAD to PDF Converter Setup Guide** for details. This also means that 3D viewing in Visual Collaboration cannot be achieved just by attaching a 3D PDF file to an item. The 3D viewer requires the scs format, which must be generated by the converter. Please contact Aras Support with any questions regarding the ability to convert and view 3D models.

9.2.1 Setting the Proper FileType for 3D PDF Files

The Aras PDF viewer is only designed to view “standard” PDF files and not 3D PDF files. Therefore, it is important that 3D PDF files be set as a separate FileType in Aras Innovator, because otherwise the PDF viewer will attempt to view them. The two standard FileType definitions exist in Aras Innovator, both with the .pdf extension. 3D PDF files generated by the Aras 3D CAD to PDF Converter are automatically set to the **3D PDF Document** FileType. However, if a 3D PDF file is manually attached to an item, it will be set to the **PDF Document** FileType. Administrators should be aware that files manually attached in this way may show up in the sidebar as an available PDF file for viewing. Users will see only a static image of the 3D model in this case.

Table 11: PDF FileTypes

FileType	Description	Ext.
PDF Document	Adobe Acrobat PDF Document	pdf
3D PDF Document	Adobe Acrobat 3D PDF Document	pdf

9.2.2 Browser Compliance Check for 3D Viewing

The 3D viewer is only supported on HTML5-compliant browsers including Firefox, Edge, and Chrome. Since Aras Innovator is supported on some browsers that do not meet this requirement, the system checks for the browser compliance when the user attempts to use the 3D viewer.

There are two cases where this check is made:

- When the user clicks on a file in the 3D viewer tab in the item window sidebar.
- When the user clicks on the View button when a markup snapshot is active in the viewer.

In each case, the user sees an error message that displays: **This web browser does not support 3D viewing. Please use a supported browser to view this file.**

9.3 Measurement Units Settings for Viewers

Both the PDF Viewer and Advanced Image Viewer provide a Measure command. Within this command is a selector to pick which measurement units to use. This list is based upon the entries specified by “Measurement Units” as found in **Contents --> Administration --> Secure Social**. By modifying these Items, you can control the entries in the list, their order, and the default.

Measurement U... x

Measurement Units

Search

Clear

Simple

	Sequence	Viewer [...]	Unit	Units	Abbreviation	Ratio to Inch	Default
	1	PDF Viewer	Millimeter	Millimeters	MM	25.4	☒
	2	PDF Viewer	Centimeter	Centimeters	CM	2.54	☐
	3	PDF Viewer	Inch	Inches	IN	1	☐
	4	PDF Viewer	Foot	Feet	FT	0.0833333	☐
	5	PDF Viewer	Yard	Yards	YD	0.0277778	☐
	6	PDF Viewer	Meter	Meters	M	0.0254	☐
	7	PDF Viewer	Kilometer	Kilometers	KM	0.0000254	☐
	8	PDF Viewer	Mile	Miles	MI	0.0000157828	☐
	101	Advanced Im...	Millimeter	Millimeters	MM	25.4	☒
	102	Advanced Im...	Centimeter	Centimeters	CM	2.54	☐
	103	Advanced Im...	Inch	Inches	IN	1	☐
	104	Advanced Im...	Foot	Feet	FT	0.0833333	☐
	105	Advanced Im...	Yard	Yards	YD	0.0277778	☐

Figure 44.

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55

9.4 Configuring Viewer Toolbars

All viewers support two styles of toolbars:

- **Basic:** has only a few commands to make it easy to use for occasional users.

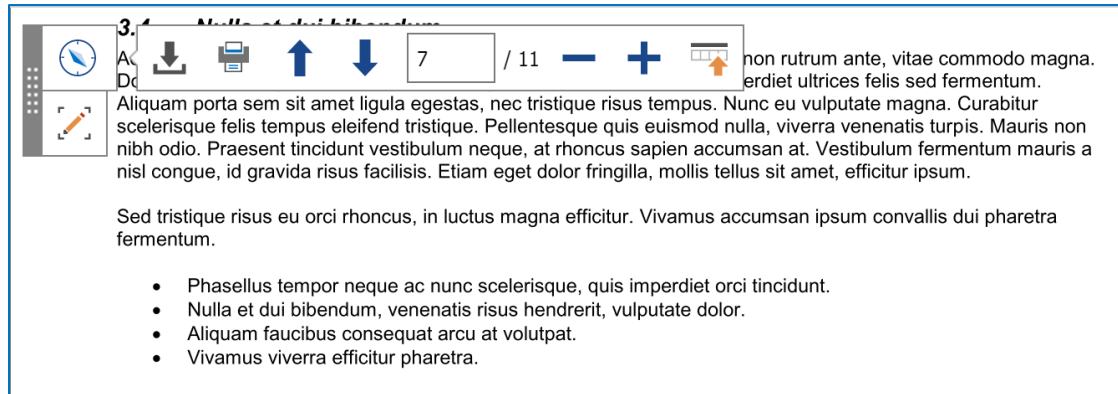


Figure 45.

- **Standard:** provides all available commands.

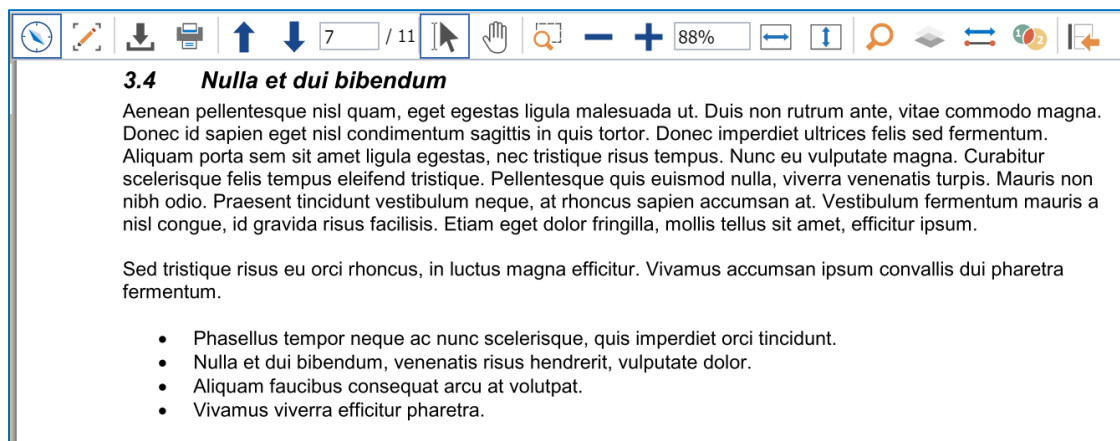


Figure 46.

Both types of toolbars are configurable based on the Aras “Command Bar” modeling capability. With this ability, the content of the toolbars can be configured based on the user’s Identity as well as item Classification. This can enable some important behaviors, such as:

- Force users to only use one or the other style of viewer toolbars (remove “Switch to Standard” or “Switch to Basic” commands).
- Remove user’s ability to download and print files, restricting them to access only in the Aras web client.
- Removal of any viewer command for any user or set of users.

9.5 Configuring Browsers for Printable View

The PDF, Image, and Advanced Image viewers provide a Printable View command which allows the user to easily view and then print the file. This command uses any available client-side PDF viewer and will use whatever is configured for the web browser in use. The quality of client-side PDF viewers varies significantly, and content displayed in some of these viewers may not match the quality of the display provided from within the Visual Collaboration PDF viewer. As a result, Aras recommends setting the browser's PDF viewer add-on to Adobe Reader or Adobe Acrobat for best results when printing. Please consult your specific web browser's help documentation for information on setting the PDF viewer add-on.

9.6 Configuring the Simulation Viewer

The Simulation Viewer can be configured to view files with the **.wcax** extension. A WCAX file must be generated using VCollab products (<https://www.vcollab.com/>).

The following steps describe how to configure the viewer for the **Document** ItemType; the same steps would work for any other ItemType.

1. Login to Aras Innovator as an administrator.
2. Go to Contents --> **Administration** --> **ItemTypes**.
3. Open the **Document** ItemType for editing.
4. Go to the **Secure Social** tab.

The screenshot shows the 'Document' ItemType configuration page in the 'Secure Social' tab. The page includes a top toolbar with 'Save', 'Done', 'Discard', and other icons. The main configuration area is divided into several sections:

- Name:** Document
- Singular Label:** Document
- Plural Label:** Documents
- History Template:** Default
- Plural Label:** Documents
- Versioning:** Versionable (checked), Discipline (Automatic), Revisions (Default)
- Search:** Auto Search (unchecked), Default Page Size (25), Max Records (empty)
- Implementation Type:** Single Item (selected), Poly Item, Federated Item
- Secure Social Enabled:** Yes
- Allow Private Permissions:** Yes
- Class Structure:** Class Structure (button)
- Small Icon:** Select an image... (button)
- Large Icon:** Select an image... (button)

Below the configuration area, there is a table with the following columns: Class path, File Selection..., Item Selection..., and Default Visibi... (truncated). The table contains one row with the value '-1' in the File Selection and Item Selection columns.

At the bottom, there is a navigation bar with 'Prev', 'Next', 'Page: 1 of 1', and '1 Results'.

Figure 47.

- Right-click the **DiscussionTemplate** and click **Secure Social** --> **Open** in the context menu.

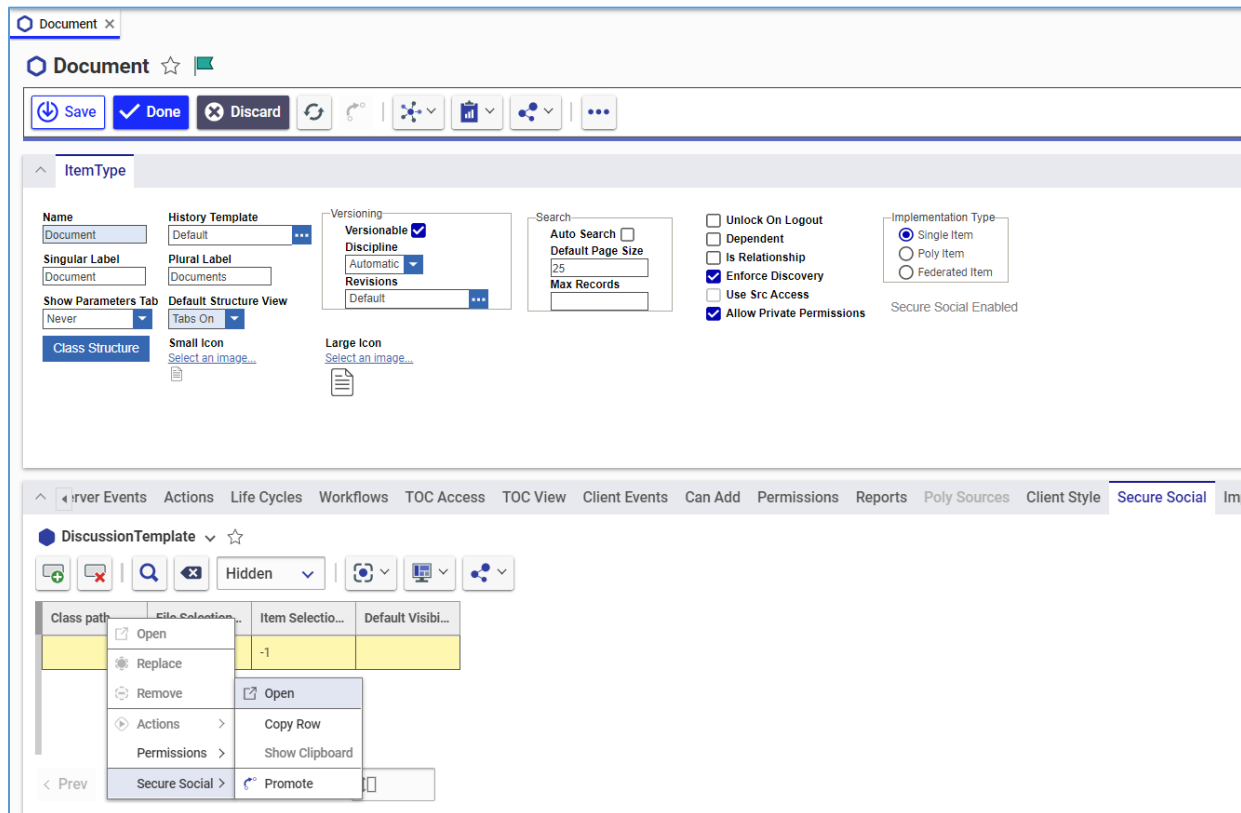


Figure 48.

- Click Edit in DiscussionTemplate.
- Click the **FeedTemplate** tab.

8. Right-click the **FeedTemplate** and click **FeedTemplate --> Open** in the context menu.

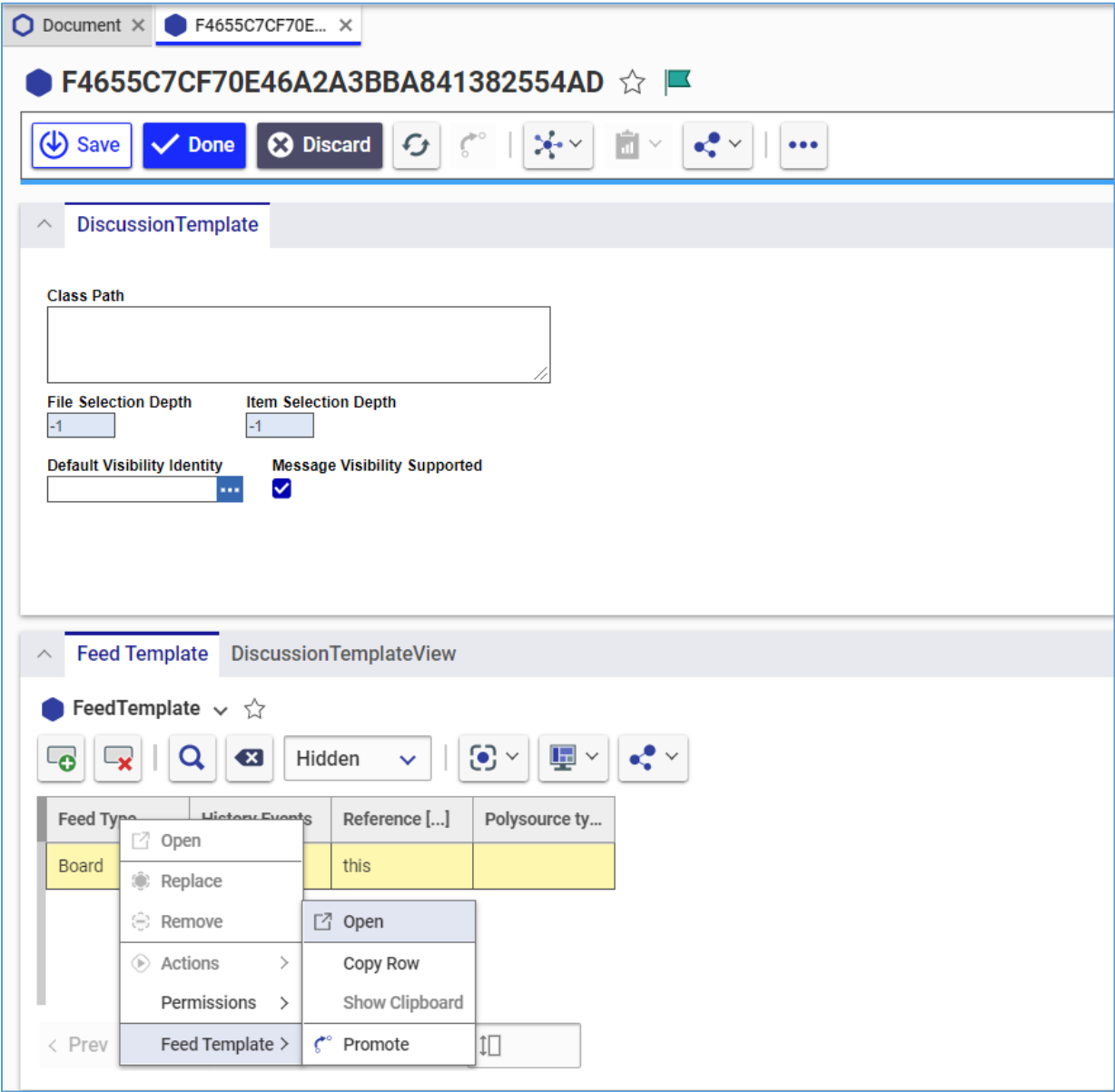


Figure 49.

- 9. Click Edit in the FeedTemplate.
- 10. Click the FeedSelectorTemplate tab.

11. Right-click the **FileSelectorTemplate** and click **FileSelectorTemplate --> Open** in the context menu.

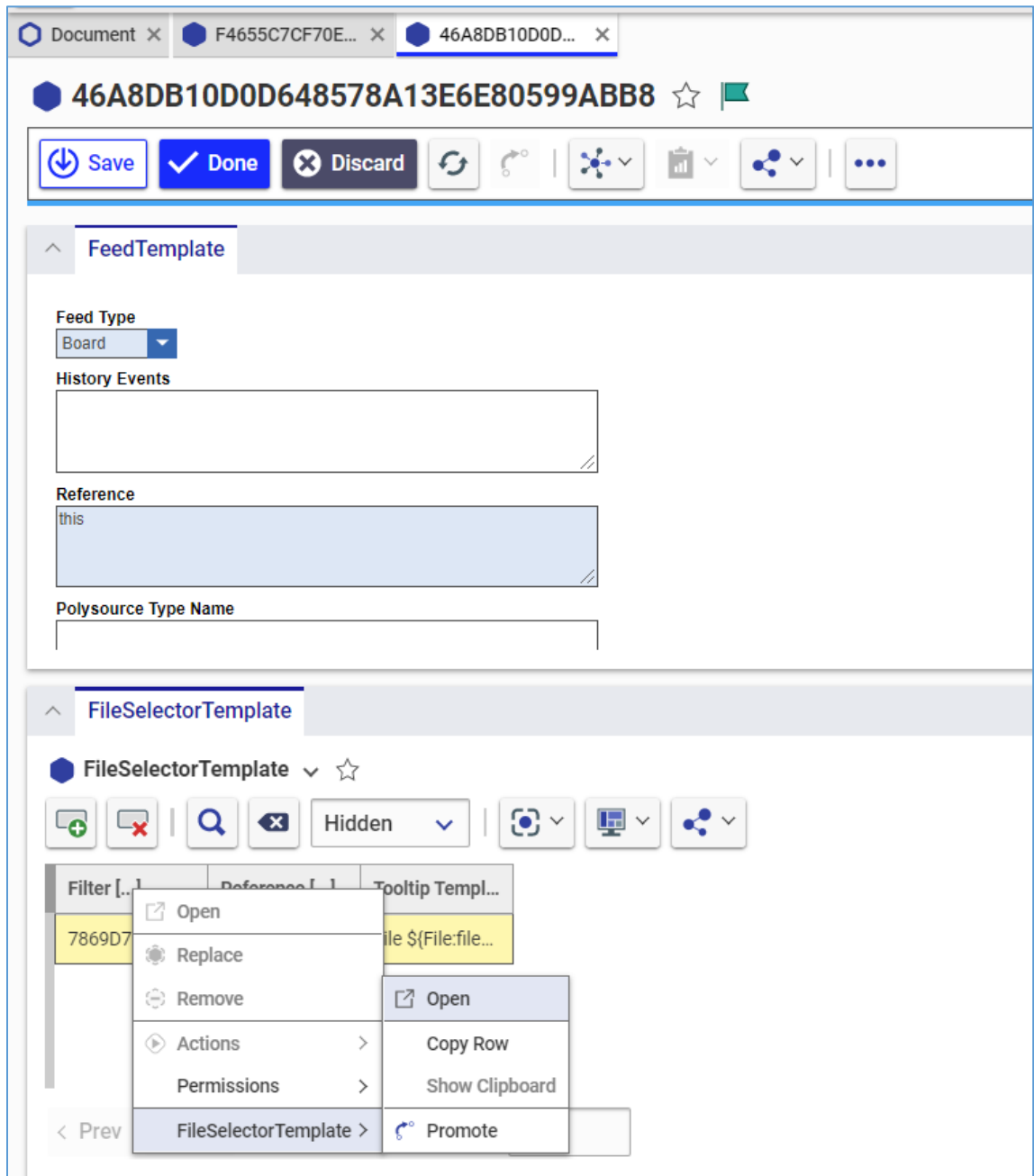


Figure 50.

12. Click Edit in the FileSelectorTemplate.
13. In the **Filter** dialog box, add the **item ID** after the **or** operator for the **FileType: wCAX 3D Model**, which is: **CE9280AD70194769A2A7B12BF8C3B32D**.

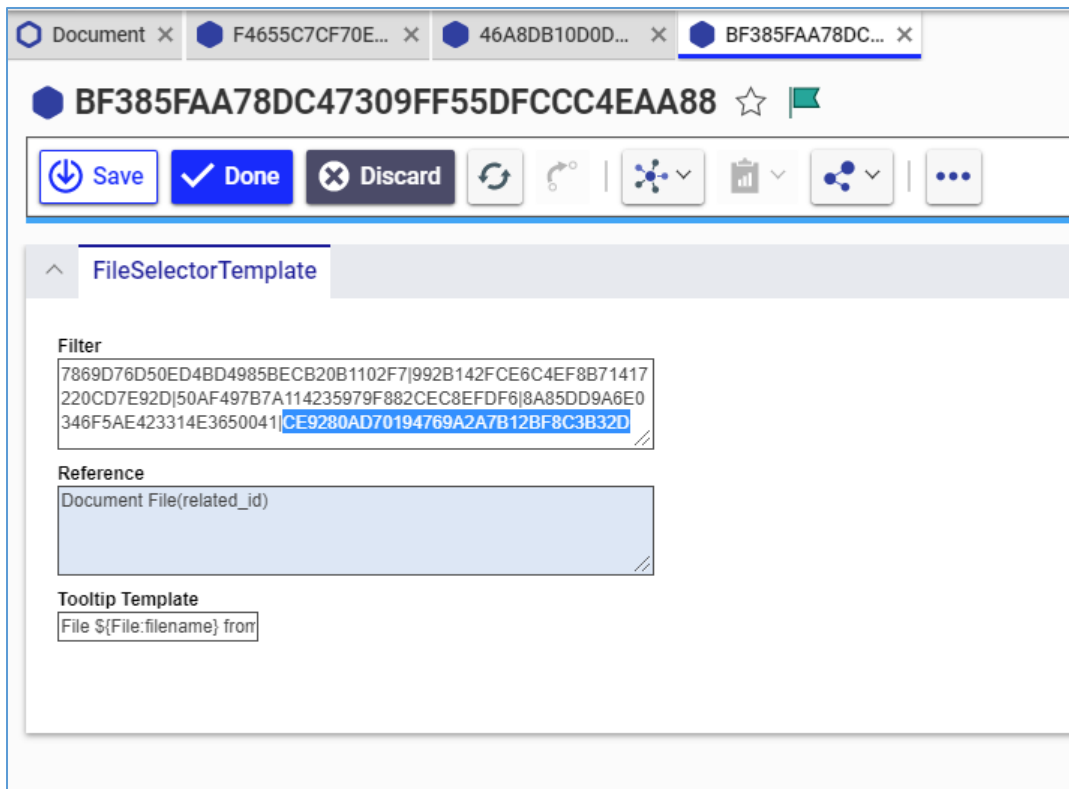


Figure 51.

14. Click  and  on the FileSelectorTemplate, FeedTemplate, Discussion Template, and ItemType (Document) toolbars.

15. When **wCAD 3D Models** with the **.wcax** extension are added to **Documents**, the **Simulation Viewer** will appear in the sidebar.

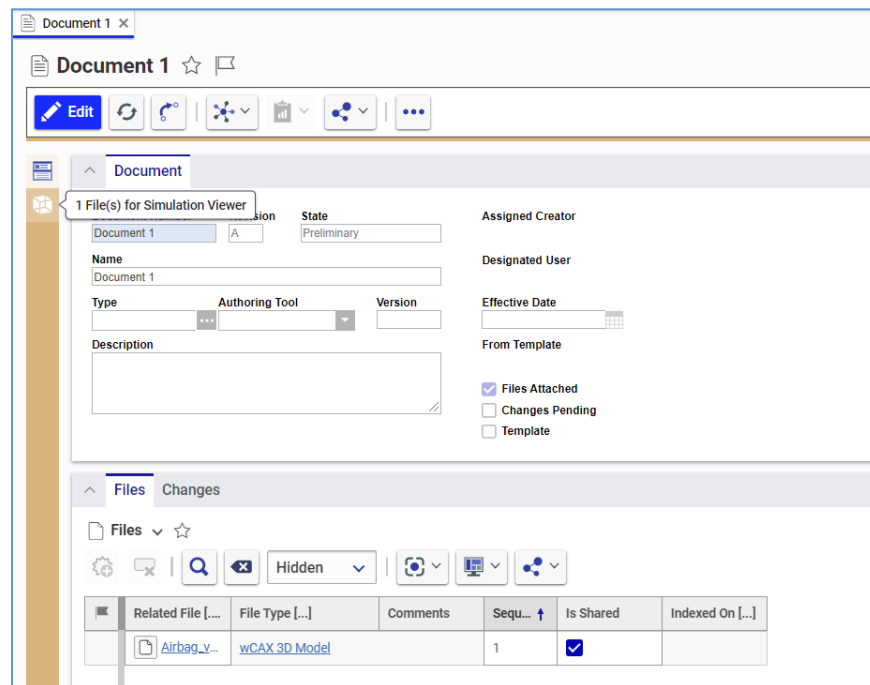


Figure 52.

16. Click the **Simulation Viewer** button in the sidebar to view the attached file in the viewer.

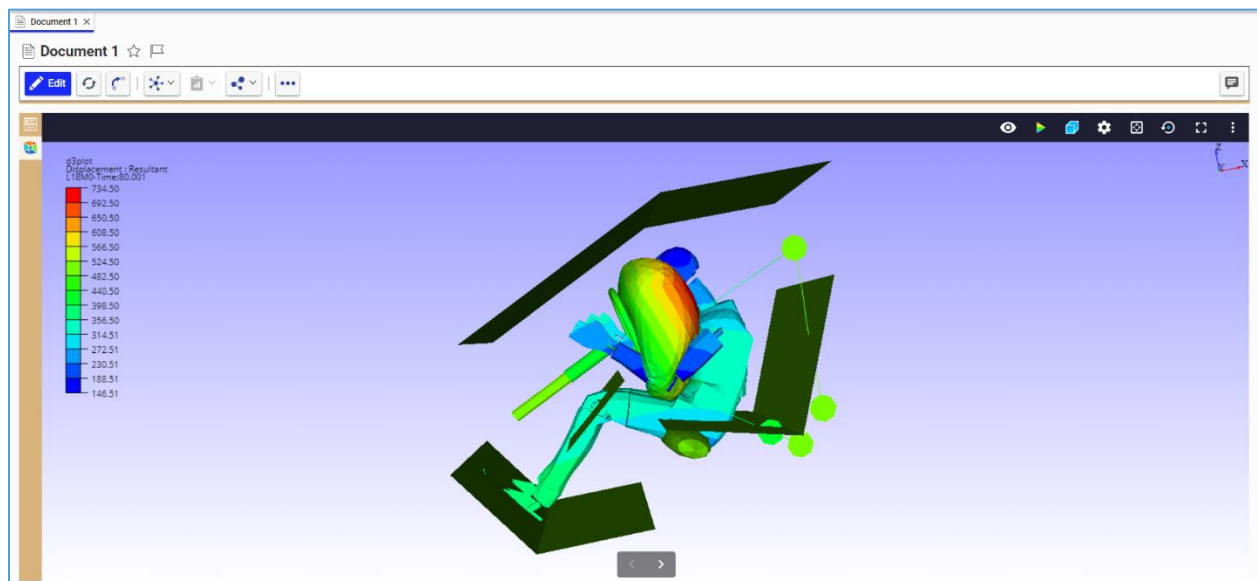


Figure 53.

10 Additional Preference Settings

In addition to preference settings described previously in this document, there are others which control various other aspects of Visual Collaboration. All settings listed here are active on a per-user basis, and if set for World act as defaults for users created later.

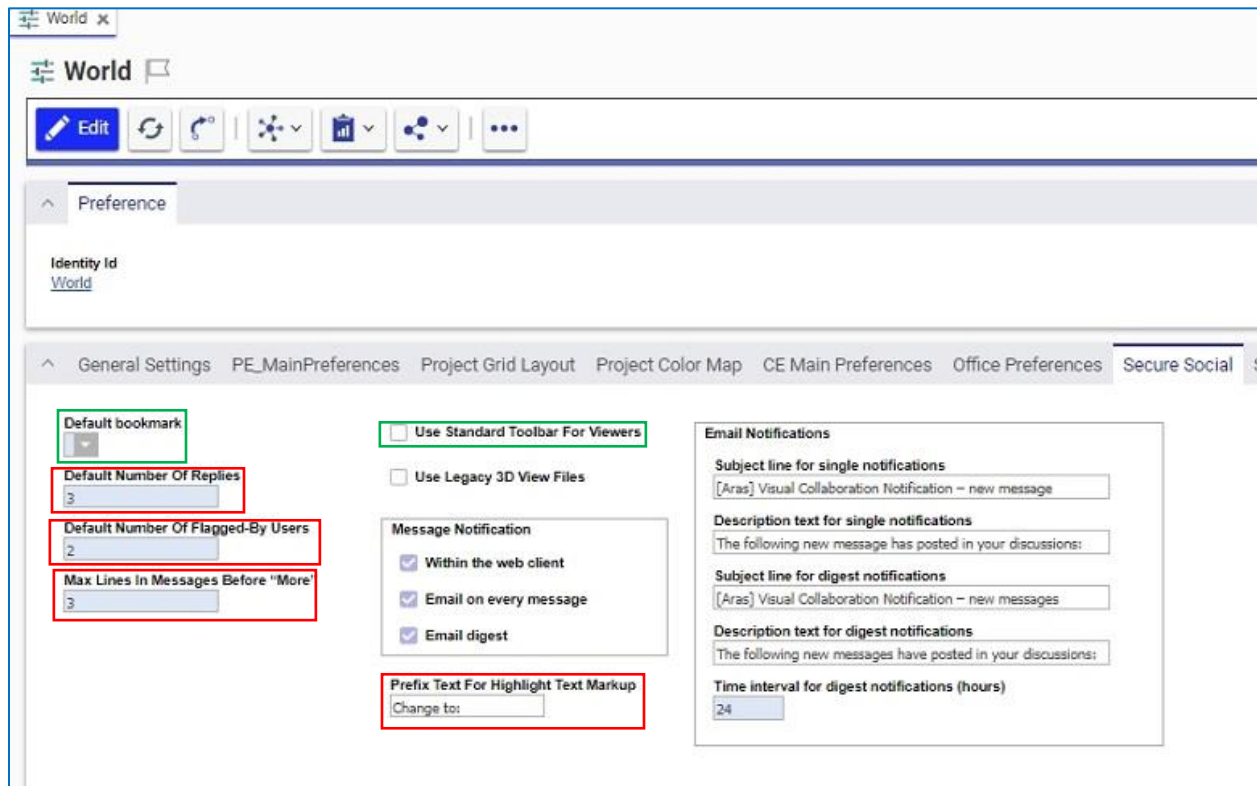


Figure 54.

Settings shown in green can be indirectly set by users based on available functions. They can also be set directly by administrators here in the Preference dialog.

- **Default Bookmark**

This setting controls the default bookmark and its associated messages that a user sees when first opening the **My Discussions** window. The standard value for the default is **All Bookmarks**. End users can change this setting using the **Set as Default** context menu command available within Bookmarks.

- **Use Standard Toolbar for Viewers**

If set to ON, it means the user is using the standard toolbars in the viewers, instead of the basic toolbars. End users can change this setting by using the Switch to Standard and Switch to Basic command available in the viewer toolbars.

Settings shown in red cannot be set directly by end users. They can only be set directly by administrators here in the Preference dialog.

- **Default number of replies**

The administrator controls the default maximum number of replies to display in the message thread. The standard value for the default is 3.

- **Default number of Flagged-By-Users**

The administrator controls how many usernames will be listed by default when the “Flagged by” list is shown. The standard value for the default is 2.

- **Maximum lines in messages before “More”**

The administrator controls how many lines of a message will be displayed by default in the discussion panel, before showing the **More** hyperlink. The standard value for the default is 3.

- **Prefix Text for Highlight Text Markup**

In the PDF viewer, if the user selects a portion of text and then picks the Markup button, it copies the selected text into the Comment box, prefixed by this text. This function is known as “Highlight Text” markup. The administrator can change this prefix text on a per user basis. Setting it to blank will result in no appended text in the Comment box.

Appendix A – Standard ItemType Configuration

The appendix defines out-of-the-box *Feeds* for some of Aras Innovator's standard ItemTypes.

Part

Aggregate messages from own *Board*, *Boards* of directly referenced CADs (i.e., first level only without further CAD dependencies), referenced Document *Boards* and *Boards* of first level *Part BOM* children. Shows files only from related CADs and Documents (does not show files from CADs and Documents of first level Part BOM children).

DiscussionTemplate

- *item_selection_depth*: 1
- *file_selection_depth*: 1

Feed 1:

- *feed_type*: Board
- *reference*: this
- *history_events*: null

Feed 2:

- *feed_type*: Discussion
- *reference*: "Part CAD(related_id)"
- *history_events*: null

Feed 3:

- *feed_type*: Discussion
- *reference*: "Part Document(related_id)"
- *history_events*: null

Feed 4:

- *feed_type*: Discussion
- *reference*: "Part BOM(related_id)"
- *history_events*: null

Document

Aggregates messages from own *Board*. Shows own files.

Feed 1:

- *feed_type*: Board
- *reference*: this
- *history_events*: null
- *{related FileSelectors}*:
 - FS1:
 - *reference*: "Document File(related_id)"
 - *filter*: { ID of "*.pdf" FileType } | {ID of "*.jpg" FileType} | {ID of "*.png" FileType} | {ID of "*.gif" FileType}

CAD Document

Aggregate messages from own *Board*. Shows own files.

Feed 1:

- *feed_type*: Board
- *reference*: this
- *history_events*: null
- *{related FileSelectors}*:
 - FS1:
 - *reference*: view_file
 - *filter*: {ID of '*.HWF' FileType}
 - FS2:
 - *reference*: viewable_file
 - *filter*: {ID of '*.pdf' FileType} | {ID of "*.jpg" FileType} | {ID of "*.png" FileType} | {ID of "*.gif" FileType}
 - FS3:
 - *reference*: "CADFiles(attached_file)"
 - *filter*: { ID of "*.pdf" FileType } | {ID of "*.jpg" FileType} | {ID of "*.png" FileType} | {ID of "*.gif" FileType}

Express ECO

Aggregate messages from own *Board* and discussions of all new “change control items” of affected items related to the ECO. Show files from all new “change control items” of affected items related to the ECO.

This is representative of the Feed definition of other Change items, including PR, ECR, ECN, Simple ECO, Simple MCO, Express DCO, and Express EDR.

DiscussionTemplate

- *item_selection_depth*: 2
- *file_selection_depth*: 2

Feed 1:

- *feed_type*: Board
- *reference*: this
- *history_events*: null

Feed 2:

- *feed_type*: Discussion
- *reference*: <Item type="Express ECO" id="{id}" action="SSVC_GetECOAffectedControlParts"/>
- *history_events*: null
- *polysource_type_name*: Part

Feed 3:

- *feed_type*: Discussion
- *reference*: <Item type="Express ECO" id="{id}" action="SSVC_GetECOAffectedControlCADs"/>
- *history_events*: null
- *polysource_type_name*: CAD

Feed 4:

- *feed_type*: Discussion
- *reference*: <Item type="Express ECO" id="{id}" action="SSVC_GetECOAffectedControlDocs"/>
- *history_events*: null
- *polysource_type_name*: Document

Notes:

- Internally all three methods must call the same “internal” parameterized method where the type of the polysource is the method parameter.
- Here is pseudo-code for the method:

```
if (new_item_id != null)
{
    if (affected_id != null && affected.config_id != new_item_id.config_id)
    {
```

```
    return messages from both affected_id and new_item_id
}
else
{
    return messages only from new_item_id
}
}
else
{
    Return messages only from affected_id
}
```

Note: It is recommended to make the Methods OS agnostic to use them with different operating systems. The main incompatibility issues in operating systems that need to be considered when implementing the methods are related to file path case-sensitivity, file path separators, OS-specific line-endings, OS-specific code. For more information about cross-platform development please see section 2.3 *Cross-platform development* in the *Aras Innovator 33 - Programmer's Guide*.

Appendix B – Notes on Exported AML

When exporting SSVC-enabled ItemTypes, the **Change Discussion Definition** Action should *not* be part of the exported AML. This Action is generated automatically by the system.

If the exported AML includes this action, the import will fail with a message that the Item already exists in the database with a different id.